“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 6

The Divine Majesty of Śrī Advaita Ācārya

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. Here the true nature and the glory of Śrīmad Advaita Ācārya Prabhu are established by examining two verses. *Māyā* has two functions (*vṛttis*): *nimitta* and *upādāna*. The *puruṣa-avatāra* seen in *prakṛti* as the efficient cause is called “Mahā-Viṣṇu.” And Mahā-Viṣṇu's second form, present in *pradhāna*, the material cause, is “Advaita.” This Advaita took on a special role as agent in the creation of the world and so on; He also accepted the mood of a devotee and taught *bhakti* to the world. To say that He is Caitanya's servant only adds to His glory, for in no *rasa* can one taste Kṛṣṇa's sweetness without the mood of a servant (*dāsya-bhāva*) contained within each of them.

By the mercy of Advaitācārya one becomes able to describe His true nature —

বন্দে তং শ্রীমদদ্বৈতাচার্য্যমদ্ভুতচেষ্টিতম্ ।
যস্য প্রসাদাদজ্ঞোঽপি তৎস্বরূপং নিরূপয়েৎ ॥ ১ ॥

vande taṁ śrīmad-advaitā-
I worship Him Śrī Advaita-

cāryam adbhuta-ceṣṭitam
-ācārya wonderful whose deeds

yasya prasādād ajño ’pi
by whose mercy an ignorant person even

tat-svarūpaṁ nirūpayet
His true nature may describe

1 I worship Śrī Advaita Ācārya, whose deeds are wonderful. By His mercy even an ignorant person can describe His true nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Śrīmad Advaitācārya, whose deeds are wondrous; by His mercy even an ignorant person can describe His true nature.

Anubhāṣya.
yasya (Advaita Prabhu's) **prasādāt** (by the mercy) **ajñaḥ api** (even an ignorant person) **tat-svarūpaṁ** (the truth about Him) **nirūpayet** (can describe), **tam adbhuta-ceṣṭitam** (Him whose deeds are wondrous) **śrīmad-advaitācāryam** (I) **vande**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaita-candra glory to Gaura's devotees host

2 All glory, all glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaita-candra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

পঞ্চ শ্লোকে কহিল শ্রীনিত্যানন্দ-তত্ত্ব ।
শ্লোকদ্বয়ে কহি অদ্বৈতাচার্য্যের মহত্ত্ব ॥ ৩ ॥

pañca śloke kahila śrī-nityānanda-tattva
in five verses I have told of Śrī Nityānanda the truth
śloka-dvaye kahi advaitācāryera mahattva
in two verses I tell of Advaita Ācārya the greatness

3 In five verses I have told the truth about Śrī Nityānanda. Now in two verses I tell the greatness of Advaita Ācārya.

Explanation of the twelfth and thirteenth of the fourteen opening verses — (a

verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

মহাবিষ্ণুর্জগৎকর্ত্তা মায়য়া যঃ সৃজত্যদঃ ।
তস্যাবতার এবায়মদ্বৈতাচার্য্য ঈশ্বরঃ ॥ ৪ ॥

mahā-viṣṇur jagat-kartā
Mahā-Viṣṇu the creator of the world
māyayā yaḥ sṛjaty adaḥ
through māyā who creates this (world)
tasyāvatāra evāyam
His avatāra indeed this
advaitācārya īśvaraḥ
Advaita Ācārya the Lord

4 Mahā-Viṣṇu, the creator of the world, creates this universe through His energy, māyā. The Lord Advaita Ācārya is His very avatāra.

Anubhāṣya.
yaḥ jagat-kartā mahā-viṣṇuḥ (the shelter of the efficient cause) **māyayā adaḥ** (this world) **sṛjati**, **tasya avatāraḥ eva ayam īśvaraḥ** (the shelter of the material cause) **advaitācāryaḥ**.

অদ্বৈতং হরিণাদ্বৈতাদাচার্য্যং ভক্তিশংসনাৎ ।
ভক্তাবতারমীশং তমদ্বৈতাচার্য্যমাশ্রয়ে ॥ ৫ ॥

advaitaṁ hariṇādvaitād
(called) Advaita being non-different from Hari
ācāryaṁ bhakti-śaṁsanāt
(called) Ācārya for proclaiming bhakti
bhaktāvatāram īśaṁ tam
the avatāra as a devotee the Lord Him
advaitācāryam āśraye
Advaita Ācārya I take shelter of

5 He is called Advaita because He is non-different from Hari, and Ācārya because He proclaims devotion (*bhakti*). I take shelter of that Lord, Advaita Ācārya, who descended as a devotee.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Mahā-Viṣṇu, who creates this world by *māyā*, is the Creator of the world; the Lord Advaitācārya is His avatāra. He is called “Advaita” because He is a *tattva* nondifferent from Hari, and “Ācārya” because He teaches *bhakti*. I take shelter of this Lord Advaitācārya, the avatāra in the form of a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

hariṇā (with the Viṣṇu-*tattva*) (in nonduality) **advaitāt** (because there is no difference) — “**advaitam**”; **bhakti-śaṁsanāt** (because He instructs in *bhajana*) — “**ācāryam**”; **bhaktāvatāram īśam tam advaitācāryam āśraye** (I surrender).

The truth of Śrī Advaita and His greatness —

অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্য গোসাঞি সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর ।
যাঁহার মহিমা নহে জীবের গোচর ॥ ৬ ॥

advaita-ācārya gosāñi sākṣāt īśvara
Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi directly the Lord
yāṅhāra mahimā nahe jīvera gocara
whose greatness not is of the jīva within the range

6 Advaita Ācārya is the Lord Himself. His greatness lies beyond the grasp of the living being (*jīva*).

The avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu —

মহাবিষ্ণু সৃষ্টি করেন জগদাদি কার্য্য ।
তাঁর অবতার সাক্ষাৎ অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য ॥ ৭ ॥

mahā-viṣṇu sṛṣṭi karena jagad-ādi kārya
Mahā-Viṣṇu creation performs of the world and other works
tāṅra avatāra sākṣāt advaita ācārya
His avatāra direct Advaita Ācārya

7 Mahā-Viṣṇu carries out the creation of the world and all the other works of the cosmos. Advaita Ācārya is His direct avatāra.

A part nondifferent from Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī —

যে পুরুষ সৃষ্টি-স্থিতি করেন মায়ায় ৷
অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড সৃষ্টি করেন লীলায় ॥ ৮ ॥

ye puruṣa sṛṣṭi-sthiti karena māyāya
which Puruṣa creation maintenance performs through māyā
ananta brahmāṇḍa sṛṣṭi karena līlāya
unlimited universes creation performs in play

8 That Puruṣa creates and maintains the world through māyā. He creates unlimited universes in play (*līlā*).

ইচ্ছায় অনন্ত মূর্ত্তি করেন প্রকাশ ৷
এক এক মূর্ত্ত্যে করেন ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে প্রবেশ ॥ ৯ ॥

icchāya ananta mūrti karena prakāśa
by His will unlimited forms He makes manifest
eka eka mūrtye karena brahmāṇḍe praveśa
in one each form He makes into a universe entrance

9 By His will He manifests unlimited forms, and in a separate form He enters each universe.

সে পুরুষের অংশ — অদ্বৈত, নাহি কিছু ভেদ ৷
শরীর-বিশেষ তাঁর — নাহিক বিচ্ছেদ ॥ ১০ ॥

se puruṣera aṁśa — advaita, nāhi kichu bheda
of that Puruṣa a portion Advaita there is not any difference
śarīra-viśeṣa tāṅra — nāhika viccheda
a body particular His there is not separation

10 Advaita is a portion of that Puruṣa, and there is no difference at all between Them. He is a particular body of the Puruṣa, never separate from Him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One and the same *māyā* is called "*pradhāna*" in its material portion (*upādāna*) and "*māyā*" in its efficient portion (*nimitta*). In keeping with these two functions of *māyā*, Mahā-Viṣṇu abides in two forms. In one form Mahā-Viṣṇu abides in *prakṛti* as the efficient cause of the world — this is the form of "Viṣṇu." In His second form He abides in *pradhāna* and, in the form of Rudra, is called "Advaita." Advaita is therefore not in the least different from the Puruṣa; only Their bodies differ.

*The presiding Lord of *pradhāna*, the material cause of the world —*

সহায় করেন তাঁর লইয়া 'প্রধান' ৷
কোটি ব্রহ্মাণ্ড করেন ইচ্ছায় নির্ম্মাণ ॥ ১১ ॥

sahāya karena tāṅra laiyā 'pradhāna'
help He gives Him taking up the pradhāna
koṭi brahmāṇḍa karena icchāya nirmāṇa
millions of universes He makes by His will the fashioning

11 He assists the Puruṣa by taking up the *pradhāna*, and by His will He fashions millions of universes.

Śrī Advaita, full of auspiciousness —

জগৎ-মঙ্গল অদ্বৈত, মঙ্গল-গুণধাম ৷
মঙ্গল-চরিত্র সদা, 'মঙ্গল' যাঁর নাম ॥ ১২ ॥

jagat-maṅgala advaita, maṅgala-guṇa-dhāma
of the world the good Advaita of auspicious qualities the abode
maṅgala-caritra sadā, 'maṅgala' yāṅra nāma
auspicious conduct always Auspicious whose name

12 Advaita is the good of the whole world, the abode of all auspicious qualities. His conduct is always auspicious, and auspiciousness itself is His name.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Advaita Prabhu is Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is the ācārya. Viṣṇu's conduct is auspicious in His very nature as the agent. When the *jīva* sees the auspiciousness in His

auspicious pastimes and in His very being, good comes to the *jīva*. He is the source of all auspiciousness. His conduct, turned toward service, brings good to everyone in the world. The worthless people of the world (“the world's encumbrance”) cannot understand this pure, eternal, complete and free auspiciousness, and so they fall away from *bhakti*, the natural function of the soul. Acts rooted in the wish to enjoy, the attainment of featureless liberation and every other inauspicious thing find no place in Śrī Advaita, who possesses spiritual qualities. Certain *jīvas* of demoniac nature, bewildered by *māyā*, failed to understand that He is the nondual Viṣṇu-*tattva*; holding to the devotionless doctrine of *kevalādvaita*, they only pretended to follow Him. The Ācārya punished these nondevotees under the guise of nourishing their self-conceit through His own *māyā*. Yet even this punishment is only an auspicious act. The Viṣṇu-*vastu*, by both the direct and the indirect way (*anvaya* and *vyatireka*), brings the *jīva* nothing but good. One who passes off the inauspicious as auspicious cannot grasp the Source of Viṣṇu's *māyā* in its material aspect. Some say that Advaita Prabhu had another name, “Maṅgala.” As a *naimittika-avatāra* (one who descends for a particular occasion), He instills into *prakṛti* the power of the material cause. He is not an inauspicious material object, nor is He the abode of inauspicious material qualities. By following His example the *jīva* attains good. When the *jīva* hears and chants His name, all that is inauspicious in it is destroyed. One must not attribute to the Viṣṇu-*vastu* any quality that is undesirable, inferior, limited or featureless. Only by gaining transcendental knowledge of His real being does the *jīva* attain the highest good (*niḥśreyasa*).

The Puruṣa creates, taking with Him countless opulences —

কোটি অংশ, কোটি শক্তি, কোটি অবতার ।
এত লঞা সৃজে পুরুষ সকল সংসার ॥ ১৩ ॥

koṭi aṁśa, koṭi śakti, koṭi avatāra
millions of portions millions of energies millions of avatāras
eta lañā sṛje puruṣa sakala saṁsāra
so many taking creates the Puruṣa the whole world

13 Taking millions of portions, millions of energies and millions of avatāras, the Puruṣa creates the whole world.

*The two forms of *māyā* —*

মায়া যৈছে দুই অংশ — 'নিমিত্ত', 'উপাদান' ।
মায়া — 'নিমিত্ত'-হেতু, উপাদান — 'প্রধান' ॥ ১৪ ॥

māyā yaiche dui aṁśa — 'nimitta', 'upādāna'
māyā just as two aspects efficient (cause) material (cause)
māyā — 'nimitta'-hetu, upādāna — 'pradhāna'
māyā the efficient cause the material (cause) the pradhāna

14 Māyā has two aspects, the efficient cause (*nimitta*) and the material cause (*upādāna*). Māyā is the efficient cause, and the *pradhāna* is the material cause.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.271.

Kāraṇaśāyī creates in two forms —

পুরুষ ঈশ্বর ঐছে দ্বিমূর্ত্তি হইয়া ।
বিশ্ব-সৃষ্টি করে 'নিমিত্ত' 'উপাদান' লঞা ॥ ১৫ ॥

puruṣa īśvara aiche dvi-mūrti haiyā
the Puruṣa the Lord in the same way two forms assuming
viśva-sṛṣṭi kare 'nimitta' 'upādāna' lañā
the universe creation performs the efficient the material (causes) taking

15 In the same way the Lord, the Puruṣa, assumes two forms and creates the universe through the efficient and the material cause.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Prakṛti has two divisions, "*nimitta*" and "*upādāna*." In the same way the Puruṣa creates the universe by taking two forms: as the *nimitta*, the form of "Mahā-Viṣṇu," and as the *upādāna*, the form of "Advaita."

Anubhāṣya.
When people try to determine the source of the visible world, two different methods of reasoning appear. According to one view, the world is created from the Reality full of being, consciousness and bliss (*sac-cid-ānanda*), but only

secondarily; primarily, that Reality manifests Goloka, Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes together with their associates. According to the other view, the source is the source of the unreal, the unconscious and the joyless: it is unknowable, unmanifest and material. The former view is upheld by Vedānta, the purpose of the Vedas and their final fruit. Sāṅkhya and other *smṛtis* put forward the opposite, latter view in order to oppose the teaching of the true Reality. The visible world is perceived, for the most part, as unconscious. In living beings there is a semblance of consciousness (*cid-ābhāsa*) bound up with the universe fashioned by *guṇa-māyā*. Some hold that even this conscious principle is produced from *prakṛti* by the *guṇas*, and on this ground they set their teaching on the material cause apart from Vedānta. But the source, the cause of all causes, is the Possessor of potency (*śaktimat-tattva*), and the potency abides in the Possessor of potency. Besides the potency from which the visible world arose, other potencies also abide eternally in that great, all-sustaining Reality. Those bound to serving the objects of the visible world perceive the worldly potency and think Bhagavān merely its possessor. They reach a false conclusion (*apasiddhānta*): that the Possessor of potency was born of a single potency, and that, since with mundane minds they see partial possessors of potency, the undivided Possessor of potency was also born of *prakṛti*. If one takes as the “source” what mundane sense-knowledge defines as knowable being and non-being, one will of course conclude that consciousness arises from the unconscious. But the actual truth rests in the true Reality, who possesses potency. There is a method that does not accept as the root cause the Reality who creates place, time and circumstance; it first takes up countless objects in all their variety and from them, relying on inference, ascends toward the One. This method is called *adhiroha-vāda*, the ascending method. In the descending (*avaroha*) method of reasoning, the Reality is the cause of all causes. Since infinite potency abides in Him, He is the Truth possessed of features (*saviśeṣa-tattva*). Even His featurelessness is but one among countless ways of considering His features. When people start from notions of unconscious objects, take Him to be an effect and search for His cause, there arises a mind like that of one who has kept company with intoxicants. In fact, the idea that inert *prakṛti* is the root cause is far from the real truth. The world, unmanifest and evolved from the unconscious potency (*acit-śakti*), comes from the power of glance (*īkṣaṇa*) of the Supreme Lord, the Possessor of infinite potencies. Only by receiving power from the All-powerful does *prakṛti* build the world, which lies in time and space and is accessible to the *jīva*'s material senses. The true Reality, who possesses infinite potencies, is perceived by the conditioned *jīva* only through the potency that builds the world.

Such errors of reasoning arise from failing to discern how the Reality is related to His potency; they give rise in the *jīva* to *vivarta*, taking one thing for another. Until the truth is revealed, the *jīva* turned away from Bhagavān wanders in the world fit for enjoyment and does not find the true Reality.

Śrīla Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa writes in the *Govinda-bhāṣya* (*Brahma-sūtra*, Chapter 2, *pāda* 2): “Kapila, the teacher of Sāṅkhya, gathered the *tattvas* as follows. *Prakṛti* is the state of equilibrium of *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. From *prakṛti* comes the *mahat*; from the *mahat*, *ahaṅkāra*; from *ahaṅkāra*, the five *tanmātras*, both kinds of senses and the gross elements; and there is the *puruṣa*. Such is the set of twenty-five. *Sattva* and the other *guṇas*, abiding in equilibrium, are *prakṛti*. They are to be understood as happiness, sorrow and delusion respectively, for in the world, their effect, everything is seen to take the form of happiness and the rest. Thus a young woman who gives her husband happiness by love is *sāttvikī*; when she gives him sorrow by her pique (*māna*) she is *rājasī*; when she bewilders him by separation she is *tāmasī*. All states are to be viewed in this way. ‘Both kinds of senses’ means the ten external senses and the one internal sense, the mind — eleven in all. *Prakṛti* is eternal and all-pervading. The root has no root; therefore the root is rootless. The material cause of all is not limited: ‘All-pervading, because effects are seen everywhere,’ say the *sūtras*. The *mahat*, *ahaṅkāra* and the five *tanmātras* are the seven *prakṛti-vikṛtis*: they are *prakṛti* (that which produces) for *ahaṅkāra* and the rest, and *vikṛti* (that which is produced) for *pradhāna* and the rest. The eleven senses and the five elements are sixteen, and they are only *vikṛtis*. The *puruṣa* does not change; therefore he is neither *prakṛti* nor *vikṛti* of anything. *Prakṛti*, however, is ever transforming. Though itself unconscious, it is the cause of the enjoyment and the liberation (*apavarga*) of many conscious beings. Though utterly beyond the senses, it is inferred from its effects. It is one, yet its *guṇas* are unequal, and by its power of transformation it gives birth to the world with its varied design, beginning with the *mahat*. Thus it is both the efficient and the material cause of the world. The *puruṣa* is inactive and without *guṇas*, an all-pervading spirit; he is distinct in each body and is inferred from the fact that composite things exist for the sake of another. Because the *puruṣa* neither changes nor acts, he is neither agent nor enjoyer. Given this nature of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, their mere proximity leads to an exchange of properties: consciousness is superimposed on *prakṛti*, and agency and enjoyment on the *puruṣa*. Thus from non-discrimination comes enjoyment, and from

discrimination, liberation. When *prakṛti* becomes indifferent, that is [liberation]. Kapila set out such points in *sūtras* with arguments. In this system he accepted perception, inference and scriptural testimony as the means of valid knowledge (*pramāṇas*): ‘The *pramāṇas* are three; when a thing is established by them, all is established; there is no further means of establishing.’ Among these, there is no great dispute about matters established by perception and scripture. But *pradhāna*, which he infers to be the cause of the world by *sūtras* such as ‘From limitation,’ ‘From uniformity,’ ‘From potency’ and others, must be refuted: by refuting it one refutes his whole doctrine. Here a doubt arises: is *pradhāna* the efficient and material cause of the world or not? [The opponent says:] *Pradhāna* is exactly that. The world is *sāttvika* and so on; therefore *pradhāna*, which consists of *sattva* and the other *guṇas*, must be inferred to be its material cause. We see that the material cause of effects like a pot is homogeneous with them — clay and the like. And just as we say ‘the tree bears fruit’ or ‘the water flows,’ so inert *pradhāna* too has the capacity to act. Therefore *pradhāna* alone is the material cause of the world and its maker. When this is proposed, [it is said] (*Brahma-sūtra*, Chapter 2, *pāda* 2):

“‘And because design is impossible, not that which is inferred’ (1).

“‘That which is inferred’ is what is inferred to be the cause of the world, namely inert *pradhāna*. It is neither the material cause of the world nor its efficient cause. Why? ‘Because design is impossible’: inert *pradhāna*, unless a conscious being directs it, cannot build the varied world. In our world, bricks and the like do not assemble into palaces and other buildings unless a conscious being directs them. The word ‘and’ adds the impossibility of concomitance (*anvaya*): external things such as pots are not endowed with the nature of happiness and the rest. Happiness and the rest are internal; pots and the like merely cause happiness and so on, and no one perceives them to be happiness themselves.

“‘And because of activity’ (2).

“Supply: ‘when the inert is directed by a conscious being.’ Clearly the activity belongs to the controller in whose presence the inert acts — as with a chariot and its driver. This also refutes ‘it bears fruit’ and the like: there too a conscious being is in control — this is known from the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa*, and it will become clear later. ‘And’ here has a restrictive sense. Or else: activity is seen only in a conscious being — ‘I do’ — therefore the inert cannot be an agent. One may object: the mere proximity of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa* leads to a mutual

superimposition of properties, and this explains the design of the world. We reply: is the proximity that causes superimposition simply their coexistence, or some change in *prakṛti* or in the *puruṣa*? Not the first, for then superimposition would occur even in the liberated. Not the second: a change in *prakṛti* is held to be an effect of superimposition and cannot be its cause, and a change in the *puruṣa* is not accepted at all.

“One may object: milk turns into curd by itself, and rainwater from a cloud, though it has a single taste, takes on varied tastes — sweet, sour and others — in the palm, the mango and other trees. In the same way *pradhāna*, because of the variety of the *puruṣas*' *karma*, takes the form of bodies, worlds and the rest. To this it is said:

“‘If [it is said:] like milk and water — there too’ (3).

“Milk and water, too, become active only when a conscious being directs them, and not by themselves: so we infer from the example of the chariot and the like. And that He directs them is established by the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa*.

“‘And because there is nothing apart [from *pradhāna*], [there can be no talk of] independence’ (4).

“‘And’ has the sense of ‘also.’ Before creation, they say, there was no other cause apart from *pradhāna*, and *pradhāna* depended on nothing. Yet even then *pradhāna* alone cannot bring about its own transformation. They accepted that before the first creation there was no cause apart from *pradhāna* to impel it or to restrain it. But then they again needed such a cause: they accepted another cause, the proximity of consciousness. Thus the doctrine that the inert alone can be an agent collapses. Moreover, if there is no separate cause and proximity is always present, effects would arise even during the dissolution of the world (*pralaya*). Nor can one say that there are no effects then because the fruits of past deeds (*adṛṣṭa*) have not awakened, for their awakening would also have to be ascribed to that very time.

“One may object: grass, creepers, leaves and the like turn into milk by their own nature, without any other cause; so too *pradhāna* turns into the *mahat* and the rest. To this it is said:

“‘And not like grass and the like, because it does not happen elsewhere’ (5).

“‘And’ is for emphasis. This argument is not clever. Why? ‘It does not happen elsewhere’: grass and the like, when eaten by a bull or a similar animal, do not turn

into milk. If grass and the like turned into milk by their own nature, the same would happen to grass fallen in a courtyard; but it does not. Therefore nature alone is not enough. This happens by the will of the Lord of all, through a connection with a particular being.

“It has been shown that *pradhāna* is inert and therefore does not act by itself. Now, to make you happy, let us grant that it does; even then nothing you wish for will follow. So it is said:

“‘And even if granted — because there is no purpose’ (6).

“‘Not’ is understood in the four [*sūtras*]. [Sāṅkhya] holds that *pradhāna* acts for the enjoyment and the liberation of the *puruṣa*: ‘The *puruṣa* will enjoy me, experience my faults and attain liberation, which is my indifference to him.’ The activity of *pradhāna* is for another's sake, since it does not enjoy anything itself, like a camel carrying saffron. And [Sāṅkhya] holds that the *puruṣa*, though not an agent, is an enjoyer: even one who does not cook enjoys the fruit, like an eater of food. But such activity is unreasonable. Why? If it is granted, it will bear no fruit. Its fruit would be the *puruṣa*'s enjoyment, that is, his beholding *prakṛti*, and his liberation, that is, the indifference of *prakṛti*. Enjoyment is impossible: before the activity begins, the *puruṣa* is pure consciousness, changeless and not an agent, and cannot undergo the change of beginning to behold *prakṛti*. Liberation is also impossible: he had it even before *prakṛti* became active, and so the activity would be pointless. And if mere proximity is the cause of enjoyment, then even the liberated will enjoy, for proximity is eternal.

“One may object: a blind man who can walk but cannot see moves through the proximity of a lame man who cannot walk but can see. Iron, though inert, moves in the presence of a magnet. So too *prakṛti*, though unconscious, in the presence of the *puruṣa*, who is pure spirit, becomes as if conscious through his reflection and acts in creation for his sake. To this it is said:

“‘If [it is said:] like a man and a stone — even then [the argument fails]’ (7).

“Even in this way one cannot prove that the inert acts by itself. The lame man, though he cannot walk, has his own capacities: he sees the road and points it out. The blind man, though he cannot see, also has capacities: he accepts directions. The magnet has nearness to the iron and so on. But the *puruṣa*, eternally inactive and without properties, undergoes no change at all. If creation is held to come from mere proximity, then, since proximity is eternal, creation would be eternal and there would be no liberation at all. Moreover, the lame man and the blind man are

both conscious, while the magnet and the iron are both inert; the examples are plainly dissimilar.

“Some hold that the universe is created when one *guṇa* rises and the others decline, so that a relation of principal and subordinate arises among them. This is refuted as follows:

“‘And because principal status is impossible’ (8).

“The state of *pradhāna* is the equilibrium of *sattva* and the other *guṇas*. In that state none of them, independent by nature, can become principal: the other two are equal to it and cannot become subordinate. Thus no relation of principal and subordinate arises among the *guṇas*. Nor can its cause be Īśvara or time, for [Sāṅkhya] does not accept them. As Kapila says: ‘Because Īśvara is not proved’; ‘He would be neither liberated nor bound; therefore He is not proved’; and ‘Space and time come from ether and the rest.’ Nor can the *puruṣa* be that cause, for he is indifferent here. Therefore a creation caused by the imbalance of the *guṇas* does not take place. Furthermore, since there is no cause, the *guṇas* might lose their balance even at the dissolution of the world, and not lose it at the first creation.

“One may object: we should infer that the *guṇas* have different natures, according to their effects; then there is no room for the fault mentioned. To this it is said:

“‘And if inferred otherwise — because they lack the power of knowing’ (9).

“Even if one infers that the *guṇas* have various powers, there is no escape from the fault. Why? ‘Because they lack the power of knowing,’ that is, because the *guṇas* do not know: they have no thought ‘I create this, and in this way.’ From the inert, devoid of knowledge, there is no creation — just as with bricks — unless a conscious being directs it.”

Kapila, the teacher of Sāṅkhya, gathered the *tattvas* as follows. In his view, “*prakṛti*” is the state of equilibrium of the three *guṇas*: *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas*. From *prakṛti* comes the *mahat-tattva*; from it, *ahaṅkāra*; from *ahaṅkāra*, the five *tanmātras*; from them, the senses of knowledge and the senses of action, and also the gross elements; and there is the “*puruṣa*.” These are the twenty-five *tattvas* in all. The three *guṇas*, *sattva* and the others, abiding in equilibrium, are *prakṛti*. These three *guṇas* are to be understood as happiness, sorrow and delusion respectively, for in the world, the effect of

prakṛti, only states such as happiness are seen. An example: a young woman who gives her husband happiness by love displays a "*sāttvika*" mood; the same woman becomes "*rājasī*" when she causes sorrow, and "*tāmasī*" when she bewilders. The words "both kinds of senses" mean the ten external senses and the one internal sense, the mind — eleven senses in all. *Prakṛti* is eternal and all-pervading. At the root there is no root (no conscious principle); therefore the root (*pradhāna*) has no root, that is, it has no other cause. This *pradhāna* is unlimited and is the material cause of everything; this follows from *sūtras* such as "All-pervading, because effects are seen everywhere." The *mahat-tattva*, the *ahaṅkāra-tattva* and the five *tanmātras* are the seven *prakṛti-vikṛtis*: they are *prakṛti* for *ahaṅkāra* and the rest, and at the same time transformations of *pradhāna*. The eleven senses and the five great elements are the sixteen transformations. The *puruṣa* does not change, and therefore he is neither *prakṛti* nor a transformation of anything. *Prakṛti* is ever transforming; though itself unconscious, it is the cause of the enjoyment and the liberation (*apavarga*) of many conscious *jīvas*; though beyond the senses, it is inferred from its effects. *Prakṛti* is one, but its *guṇas* are unequal, and so by its power of transformation it gives birth to a world full of varied creations, beginning with the *mahat*. Thus *prakṛti* is both the efficient and the material cause of the world. The *puruṣa* is inactive, without *guṇas* and all-pervading. He is spiritual by nature and distinct in each body; he is inferred from the way *pradhāna* is set in motion. Because the *puruṣa* neither changes nor acts, he is neither agent nor enjoyer. Such is the truth of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, and therefore their mere proximity leads to an exchange of properties: consciousness is superimposed on *prakṛti*, and agency and enjoyment on the *puruṣa*. While there is no such discrimination, there is enjoyment; with discrimination comes *apavarga*, that is, liberation. These and other points — for example, the *puruṣa*'s indifference toward *prakṛti* — are set out in *sūtras* with arguments. In his system the author of Sāṅkhya accepted three means of knowledge (*pramāṇas*): "perception," "inference" and "scripture" (*āgama*). When something is established by them, all is established. (Comparison and the other *pramāṇas* are included in these three and are not separate *pramāṇas*.) There is no great dispute about matters established by perception and scripture. But now we must refute the claim that *pradhāna* is the cause of the world, which is inferred by *sūtras* such as "From limitation," "From uniformity," "From potency" and others; for by refuting this view one refutes all the other views of Sāṅkhya. The doubt here is this: is "*pradhāna*" the efficient and the material cause of the world or not? The *pūrvapakṣa* grants *pradhāna*

both. The *pūrvapakṣa* says: *pradhāna*, consisting of *sattva* and the rest, is inferred precisely as the material cause of the world. The material cause is always homogeneous with the effect: thus for a pot and similar things the material cause is clay and the like, which is homogeneous with them. An inert tree bears fruit; equally inert water flows; seeing this, one concludes that inert, unconscious *pradhāna* too is able to create the world. So: "*pradhāna* is both the material and the efficient cause of the world." To refute this conclusion of the *pūrvapakṣa*, the author introduces the first *sūtra*.

Pradhāna is unconscious; therefore inert *pradhāna* cannot be either the material or the efficient cause of the world. Looking at the varied design of this world, it is clear that inert *pradhāna* cannot build the visible world without the direction of a conscious being, and that it is unreasonable to infer so. In this world, bricks and the like have never yet assembled into palaces and similar buildings unless a conscious being directed them. The word "and" in the *sūtra* adds the impossibility of concomitance (*anvaya*). External objects such as pots are never endowed with the nature of happiness and the like. For happiness and the rest are internal properties, and therefore they cannot accompany external things. Above all, a pot and the like merely cause happiness and so on; they themselves are not perceived as happiness.

The second *sūtra*. Even if we look at activity, *pradhāna* cannot be the cause. Activity is seen only in what is inert and directed by a conscious being. Clearly that activity belongs to the one under whose direction the inert is set in motion. The best example is a chariot and its driver. The same holds for the example "the tree bears fruit" and similar ones offered in support of *pradhāna* as the cause. There too the direction of a conscious being is accepted, for the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa* speaks of it; this will be explained later in this commentary. The word "and" in the *sūtra* has a restrictive sense. In the example "I am doing," activity is seen only in a conscious being; therefore the inert cannot be an agent. You may say: the world is designed because, through the mere proximity of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, their properties are superimposed on each other. The answer: this cannot be said either. Very well — is the proximity that causes the mutual superimposition of properties the coexistence of *prakṛti* and *puruṣa*, or some change in *prakṛti* or in the *puruṣa*? The answer: it can by no means be their coexistence, for if we accept that, we must accept superimposition in all liberated *puruṣas* as well. Nor can this proximity be a change in *prakṛti*: a change in *prakṛti* is considered an effect of superimposition and so cannot be its cause. Nor can it be a change in the

puruṣa: a change in the *puruṣa* cannot be accepted either. Therefore "*pradhāna*" cannot be the cause of the world.

You may say: as milk turns into curd by itself, and as the water from a single cloud, though it has one taste, becomes sweet, sour and of many tastes in the fruits of the palm, the mango and other trees, so the one *pradhāna*, according to the variety of the *puruṣas*' *karma*, transforms into bodies, worlds and the rest. In reply the author says:

The third *sūtra*. Unconscious things such as milk and water also act in their effects only when a conscious being directs them; they are not set in motion by themselves: so it is inferred from the example of the chariot and the like. And from the *Antaryāmi-brāhmaṇa* it is established that these two inert things are directed by consciousness.

The fourth *sūtra*. The claim that there is no cause apart from *pradhāna* had to be abandoned; therefore the claim that *pradhāna* alone is the agent is also untenable. The word *api* means the same as *ca*, that is, "and" (conjunction). The view that before creation there was no cause apart from *pradhāna* has been given up; therefore the view that *pradhāna* alone transforms itself is also refuted. The view that "before the first creation there is no other cause apart from *pradhāna* to impel it or restrain it" has been set aside, for at that point another cause is accepted — the proximity of the conscious principle. Therefore the doctrine that the inert alone is the agent is refuted. Moreover, under such a *pūrvapakṣa* effects would arise even during the dissolution of the world: since there is no cause apart from *pradhāna* and proximity to it remains, effects would arise at *pralaya* just as at creation. Nor can one say that there are no effects at *pralaya* because the *adṛṣṭa* has not awakened, for the awakening of that *adṛṣṭa* might also come at that very time.

You may say: as grass, leaves and the like, eaten by a cow or another animal, turn into milk by themselves, so *pradhāna* transforms into the *tattvas* beginning with the *mahat*. In reply the author says:

The fifth *sūtra*. Elsewhere grass does not turn into milk; therefore one cannot say that *pradhāna*, like grass, transforms by its own nature (by itself). The word "and" here is for affirmation. Such a *pūrvapakṣa* is untenable, for this is not seen elsewhere: grass eaten by a bull or a similar animal does not turn into milk, and so the transformation is not natural. Besides, if grass and the like turned into milk by their own nature, this would be seen in a courtyard too. Since it is not seen, nature

alone cannot be called the cause of the transformation; its cause is the will of the Lord of all: “Let grass, in connection with particular living beings, turn into milk.”

It has been proved that *pradhāna* is inert and therefore does not come into action by itself. Next the author says: even if, to please you, I grant it, nothing you desire will follow.

The sixth *sūtra*. Even if one grants that *pradhāna* acts by its own nature, there is no purpose in it. In four *sūtras* the sense “not” is understood. It seems that *pradhāna* acts for the sake of enjoyment and liberation: “The *puruṣa* will enjoy me, feel my faults and attain liberation, that is, indifference toward me.” As a camel carries a load of saffron only for others and does not enjoy it itself, so *pradhāna* acts only for the sake of others. And the *puruṣa*, it seems, though not an agent, is an enjoyer. As an eater enjoys food though he has not cooked it, so the *puruṣa* tastes the fruits. But to hold, with the *pūrvapakṣa*, that *pradhāna* acts in this way is unreasonable: even if it is granted, no fruit is seen. The fruit of the activity is the *puruṣa*'s enjoyment, that is, beholding *prakṛti*, and liberation, that is, indifference toward *prakṛti*. Enjoyment from the activity of *pradhāna* is impossible, for then the *puruṣa* — pure consciousness, changeless and not an agent — would enjoy only because, by beholding *prakṛti*, he came into contact with it and underwent change. *Apavarga* from the activity of *pradhāna* is also impossible: *apavarga* existed even before the activity arose, and so the activity is useless. And if mere proximity is called the cause of enjoyment, then, since proximity is eternal, even the liberated will have to enjoy.

You may say: a blind man who can walk but cannot see begins to move near a lame man who cannot walk but can see; and inert iron also moves near a magnet. So too *prakṛti*, though unconscious, near the *puruṣa*, who is pure consciousness, under the influence of his reflection sets about creation and the rest for the *puruṣa*'s enjoyment, as if it were a conscious being. In reply the author says:

The seventh *sūtra*. Even if the *puruṣa* is like a magnet, inert *pradhāna* does not act by itself. Even so, one cannot prove that the inert acts by itself. The lame man cannot walk, yet he has his own capacities — to point out the road and to give directions. The blind man cannot see, yet he too has a capacity — to accept the lame man's directions. And a magnet can come near iron. But the eternally inactive *puruṣa*, devoid of properties, undergoes no change whatever. If proximity itself is accepted as change, then, since proximity is eternal, one must accept eternal creation and the absence of liberation. Above all, the lame man and the blind man

are both conscious, while the magnet and the iron are both inert; the examples are plainly dissimilar.

Next the author refutes the view that the universe is created because the *guṇas* rise and decline and a relation of principal and subordinate arises among them:

The eighth *sūtra*. The principal status of a *guṇa* is impossible in itself; therefore this view is untenable. The abiding of the *guṇas* — *sattva* and the rest — in equilibrium is called “the state of *pradhāna*.” In that state the *guṇas* are independent by nature, and so none of them proves to be principal over another. For if one of the three *guṇas* is accepted as principal, the other two, being equal to it, cannot become subordinate. A relation of principal and subordinate among the *guṇas* never arises. Nor can Īśvara or time be called its maker, for no one [among them] accepts this. Kapila himself said: “Since [Īśvara] could be neither liberated nor bound — that is, since there is no proof — Īśvara is not proved.” Space and time arise from ether and the rest; the *puruṣa* is not their maker, for he is entirely indifferent to activity. Nor is an imbalance of the *guṇas* the cause of creation. Moreover, since there is no cause, the *guṇas* might lose their balance at every later creation, but not at the first.

You may say: one can infer that the *guṇas*, according to their effects, are of different natures; then there is no room for the fault mentioned. In reply the author says:

The ninth *sūtra*. Even if one infers otherwise, the inert does not act by itself. That is, even if one infers that the *guṇas* are endowed with such varied powers, there is no escaping the fault: the *guṇas* lack the capacity to know (consciousness); evidently they do not have even the thought “Here I am, and this is how I create.” Creation from inert matter devoid of knowledge is never possible. As bricks, wood and other unconscious things can do nothing unless a conscious being directs them, so the unconscious *guṇas* can do nothing unless the potency of the conscious Supreme Lord directs them.

(Chapter 2, *pāda* 1.) “The great sage Kapila, desiring liberation, composed the *smṛti* [Sāṅkhya] to elaborate the meaning of the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. He duly accepted the *agnihotra* and the other rites enjoined by the *karma-kāṇḍa*, and the Śrutis recognize him as trustworthy: ‘the sage Kapila, born [in the beginning],’ and so on. By his *sūtras* ‘Now, the complete cessation of the threefold misery is the highest goal of man,’ ‘Not by visible means, for even after cessation [misery] returns’ and others, it is established there that the cause of the world is

unconscious, independent *pradhāna* alone; [this is also said in the *sūtras*] ‘For the liberation of the liberated,’ ‘Or for its own sake — of *pradhāna*,’ ‘Though *pradhāna* is unconscious, its activity is like that of milk’ and others. If Brahman is accepted as the cause, this *smṛti* will be left without a subject, for the whole of it speaks of nothing but *pradhāna*. Therefore Vedānta should be interpreted so as not to contradict the *smṛti* of Kapila, who is entirely trustworthy. The *smṛtis* of Manu and others will not be left without a subject, for by setting forth *dharma* they elaborate the meaning of the *karma-kāṇḍa* and so have their own subject. When this is proposed, it is said:

“‘If [it is said:] there follows the fault that the *smṛti* has no room — no, for there follows the fault that other *smṛtis* have no room’ (1).

“‘Has no room’ means is left without a subject. If Vedānta is interpreted according to its single import (*samanvaya*), the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* incurs the fault of being left without a subject; so must [the texts of Vedānta] be interpreted in a sense contrary to the Śruti? If that is said — no. Why? ‘Other’ and so on. For then a great fault would arise: other *smṛtis* would be left without a subject — the *smṛtis* of Manu and others, which follow Vedānta and teach that Brahman alone is the cause. In them the Lord of all is shown to be the cause of the origin of the world and the rest, and by no means some other principle named by Kapila. Thus Śrīman Manu says: ‘This [world] was darkness — unknown, without marks, beyond reasoning, unknowable, as if wholly asleep. Then the self-born Bhagavān, unmanifest, manifesting this [world] — the great elements and the rest — appeared in full power, dispelling the darkness. He who is beyond the senses, imperceptible, subtle, unmanifest, eternal, containing all beings and inconceivable — He Himself appeared. Wishing to create various beings from His own body, He reflected and first created the waters, and placed a seed in them. It became a golden egg, shining like the sun; in it Brahmā himself was born, the grandfather of all the worlds,’[3] and so on. Śrī Parāśara says: ‘From Viṣṇu the world arose, and in Him it abides; He is the one who maintains and dissolves this world, and He is the world’;[4] ‘As a spider draws a thread from its heart through its mouth, plays with it and swallows it again, so does Janārdana,’ and so on. Others speak in the same way. Nor can one say that these *smṛtis* have their subject in elaborating the meaning of the *karma-kāṇḍa*. They enjoin *dharmas* for purifying the mind, so that knowledge of Brahman may dawn, and therefore their purpose is only to elaborate the meaning of the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. That they purify the mind is seen from the Śruti: ‘Him [the *brāhmaṇas*

seek to know] by the study of the Vedas,'[5] and so on. Here and there one sees and experiences that they bring such fruits as rain, sons, heaven and the like. But this too, by creating trust in the scriptures, finally leads to Him, for it is said: 'The goal that all the Vedas proclaim'[6] and 'The Vedas are devoted to Nārāyaṇa.'[7] The Sāṅkhya *smṛti* cannot elaborate the meaning of Vedānta, for it teaches what contradicts the Śruti. Elaboration (*upabṛṁhaṇa*) is the clarifying of a meaning that agrees with the Śruti, and in it there is no such thing. Therefore the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*, which contradicts the Śruti, is invented out of its author's own head and is not trustworthy; and we do not fear the charge that it will prove useless. Nor is it right to favor that *smṛti* on the pretext that it is trustworthy. Many interpreters are declared trustworthy, and their *smṛtis* differ in meaning; if one favors one of them, the real meaning will never be settled. When *smṛtis* contradict one another, there is no other way to decide than to rely on the Śruti; therefore one should honor only the *smṛti* that follows the Śruti. You object by the strength of *smṛti* — by the strength of *smṛti* we shall refute you: thus the fault 'other *smṛtis* have no room' is pointed out. Some cite the *Śvetāśvatara-śruti* as proof that Kapila is trustworthy: 'He who in the beginning endowed the born sage Kapila with knowledge.'[8] But this is not so: those words speak of someone else, and one whose words contradict the meaning of the Śruti cannot be trustworthy. As for Manu's trustworthiness, the Taittirīyas recite: 'Whatever Manu said is medicine.' And of Śrī Parāśara tradition says that he understood the highest truth about the Deity by the grace of Pulastya and Vasiṣṭha. Kapila, the founder of the *smṛti* opposed to the Vedas, is a particular *jīva* of the line of Agni, deluded by *māyā*, and not Vāsudeva born of Kardama. For tradition says: 'Kapila, called Vāsudeva, taught the doctrine of Sāṅkhya to Brahmā and the other gods, to Bhṛgu and others, and likewise to Āsuri; all of it was elaborated by the meaning of the Vedas. But another Kapila taught a doctrine opposed to all the Vedas'; '[he taught] Sāṅkhya to another Āsuri, elaborated with false arguments.' Therefore, if the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*, untrustworthy because it contradicts the Vedas, proves useless, there is no fault in that.

"'And because the rest is not found' (2).

"'And the rest,' that is, what the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* speaks of, is not found in the Vedas; therefore it is not trustworthy. These are its tenets: the *puruṣas* are all-pervading and are consciousness alone; *prakṛti* alone binds and liberates them, and bondage and liberation belong to *prakṛti* alone; there is no Lord of all, a

special Puruṣa; time is not a *tattva*; the five *prāṇas* and the rest are merely functions of the senses. Such tenets and others like them are to be seen in it."

1. The Śruti mentions a trustworthy sage named "Kapila." He duly accepted the *karma-kāṇḍa* enjoined by the Vedas. This same sage Kapila composed the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* in order to elaborate the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. In *sūtras* such as "Now, the complete cessation of the threefold misery is the highest goal of man," the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* calls the complete cessation of the threefold misery — *ādhyātmika* and the rest — "the highest goal of man," or liberation. In it unconscious *pradhāna* alone is established as the independent cause of the world. If Brahman alone is called the sole cause of the world, this Sāṅkhya *smṛti* will be left without a subject, for from beginning to end it speaks of nothing else. Therefore the texts of Vedānta should be interpreted so as not to contradict the views of the entirely trustworthy sage Kapila. Then the *smṛtis* proclaimed by Manu and others will not be left without a subject either: by setting forth *dharma* they elaborate the *karma-kāṇḍa* and so have a subject. To refute this, the author introduces the first *sūtra*, "If [it is said:] there follows the fault that the *smṛti* has no room…".

Absence of room is *anavakāśa*; the word *anavakāśa* means being left without a subject. If Vedānta is interpreted according to its single import (*samanvaya*), the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* incurs the fault of being left without a subject. So should the texts of Vedānta be interpreted in a sense opposite to what one hears in them? The answer: that is impossible. If they are interpreted so, a great calamity follows: other *smṛtis* — those of Manu and others, which follow Vedānta and teach that Brahman alone is the cause — will be left without a subject. In these *smṛtis* only the Lord of all is shown to be the cause of the origin of the world and the rest. The *tattvas* are not described in them as the sage Kapila describes them. Thus Śrī Manu says: "Before creation the whole universe was darkness — unknown, without marks, beyond reasoning, unknowable — and lay as if asleep. Then the self-born Bhagavān, though Himself unmanifest, appeared endowed with the potencies of the great elements and the rest in order to manifest this world, and dispelled that darkness. He is beyond the senses, imperceptible, subtle, unmanifest, eternal, containing all beings and inconceivable by nature. Having appeared Himself, He desired in His mind to create various beings from His own body, and first of all He created water. Then the Supreme Lord placed His seed in that water. From the seed arose a golden egg, shining like a thousand suns. In that egg Brahmā himself, the grandfather of all the worlds, was born." And the sage Parāśara says:

“The visible world arose from Bhagavān Viṣṇu and abides resting on Him. He maintains it and He destroys it. This world is a particular potency of His. As a spider draws threads out of its own body and later swallows them itself, so Bhagavān Viṣṇu creates the universe from His potency and later dissolves it again in His potency.” Other sages say the same. Nor can one say that the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*[9] will have a subject by elaborating the *karma-kāṇḍa*: [these *smṛtis*] enjoin *dharma* for the purification of the mind, so that knowledge of Brahman may dawn. Therefore the purpose of these *smṛtis* is to elaborate the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*. It is also seen that these *dharmas* purify the mind: the words of the Śruti “Him [the *brāhmaṇas* seek to know] by the study of the Vedas” and so on are the proof. Here and there it is seen and confirmed that these *dharmas* (their performance) bring such fruits as rain, sons, heaven and the like. But this too is only to purify the mind by creating faith in the scriptures. The Śrutis “The goal that all the Vedas proclaim” and “The Vedas are devoted to Nārāyaṇa” express the same intention. Even if the purpose of the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* is to elaborate the *jñāna-kāṇḍa*, one still cannot accept that it elaborates the meaning of Vedānta, for the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* teaches what contradicts the Śruti. To clarify the meaning of the statements of the Śruti — that is what “elaboration” (*upabṛṁhaṇa*) means. No such clarification of the meaning of the Śruti is seen in the Sāṅkhya *smṛti*. It must therefore be judged contrary to the Śruti. And what contradicts the Śruti is invented out of one's own head and is therefore untrustworthy. So the uselessness of this untrustworthy Sāṅkhya *smṛti* is inevitable. Nor is it right to favor one *smṛti* while waiting for the untrustworthiness of another to be established. If one favors *smṛtis* that differ in meaning, then, faced with the many opinions of Gautama and many others who interpret in different ways, one will never settle the real meaning. When two *smṛtis* contradict each other, one cannot resort to any deciding proof other than the Śruti. Whatever one relies on must certainly follow the Śruti; if it does not follow the Śruti, it cannot be honored. Those who raise censure by the strength of *smṛti* will be refuted by the strength of that same *smṛti*; therefore pointing out the fault “other *smṛtis* will be left without a subject” is unavoidable. In the *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* the words “the sage Kapila, born…” and so on do speak of a trustworthy sage Kapila. But that Kapila is not this one; he is another sage Kapila. Therefore, in calling Kapila, the author of Sāṅkhya, untrustworthy, we show no disrespect to the Śruti. The trustworthiness of Manu and Parāśara is well known from the Śruti and the *smṛti*. Thus with the words “Whatever Manu said is medicine” the Taittirīyas affirm Manu's

trustworthiness. And the *smṛti* says that Śrī Parāśara understood the highest truth about the Deity by the grace of Pulastya and Vasiṣṭha. Kapila, the founder of the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* opposed to the Vedas, and Bhagavān Kapila, the son of Kardama, are not the same person. The first Kapila is a particular *jīva* of the line of Agni, deluded by *māyā*; the second, the son of Kardama, is an avatāra of Vāsudeva Himself. The *Padma Purāṇa* says: "Bhagavān Vāsudeva descended from the sage Kardama as Kapila and taught the doctrine of Sāṅkhya to the gods headed by Brahmā, to the sages headed by Bhṛgu and to a *brāhmaṇa* named Āsuri; the Sāṅkhya *smṛti* He taught is elaborated by the meaning of the Vedas. But another Kapila taught another Āsuri a different Sāṅkhya — opposed to all the Vedas, elaborated with false arguments and invented out of his own head." Therefore there is no fault whatever in calling this latter Sāṅkhya *smṛti*, opposed to the Vedas and untrustworthy, useless.

2. Moreover, this Sāṅkhya *smṛti* speaks of certain matters that are not found in the Vedas. For this reason too it can be called "untrustworthy." These are the matters: "The *puruṣas*, that is, the individual souls, are consciousness alone and all-pervading; *prakṛti* alone binds and liberates them. Both 'bondage' and 'liberation' are material. There is no *puruṣa* called 'the Lord of all.' 'Time' is not a *tattva* at all. The five *prāṇas* and the rest are merely functions of the senses." These and certain other tenets opposed to Vedānta are seen in this Sāṅkhya *smṛti*.

He Himself is the "efficient" cause, and Advaita Prabhu the "material" cause

—

আপনে পুরুষ — বিশ্বের 'নিমিত্ত'-কারণ ।
অদ্বৈত-রূপে 'উপাদান' হন নারায়ণ ॥ ১৬ ॥

āpane puruṣa — viśvera 'nimitta'-kāraṇa
Himself the Puruṣa of the world the efficient cause
advaita-rūpe 'upādāna' hana nārāyaṇa
of Advaita in the form the material (cause) becomes Nārāyaṇa

16 The Puruṣa Himself is the efficient cause of the world, and in the form of Advaita, Nārāyaṇa becomes the material cause.

As the one who casts the glance He is the efficient cause, and as Advaita He is the Creator in the form of the material cause —

'নিমিত্তাংশে' করে তেঁহো মায়াতে ঈক্ষণ ।
'উপাদান' অদ্বৈত করেন ব্রহ্মাণ্ড-সৃজন ॥ ১৭ ॥

'nimittāṁśe' kare teṅho māyāte īkṣaṇa
as the efficient aspect casts He on māyā a glance
'upādāna' advaita karena brahmāṇḍa-sṛjana
as the material (cause) Advaita performs of the universes creation

17 As the efficient aspect, He glances at māyā; as the material cause, Advaita creates the universes.

Refutation of the Sāṅkhya doctrine —

যদ্যপি সাংখ্য মানে, 'প্রধান' — কারণ ।
জড় হইতে কভু নহে জগৎ-সৃজন ॥ ১৮ ॥

yadyapi sāṅkhya māne, 'pradhāna' — kāraṇa
although the Sāṅkhya holds the pradhāna the cause
jaḍa haite kabhu nahe jagat-sṛjana
from inert matter ever not is of the world creation

18 Although the Sāṅkhya philosophy holds that the *pradhāna* is the cause, the world can never come into being from inert matter.

**Prakṛti* acts only by the potency of Bhagavān —*

নিজ সৃষ্টিশক্তি প্রভু সঞ্চারে প্রধানে ।
ঈশ্বরের শক্ত্যে তবে হয়ে ত' নির্ম্মাণে ॥ ১৯ ॥

nija sṛṣṭi-śakti prabhu sañcāre pradhāne
His own creative power the Lord infuses into the pradhāna
īśvarera śaktye tabe haye ta' nirmāṇe
of the Lord by the power then there is indeed creation

19 The Lord infuses His own creative power into the *pradhāna*, and only then, by the Lord's power, does creation take place.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.58–66; Madhya 20.259–261, 271, 276.

The two forms of Advaita Prabhu —

অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্য — কোটিব্রহ্মাণ্ডের কর্ত্তা ।
আর এক এক মূর্ত্ত্যে ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের ভর্ত্তা ॥ ২০ ॥

advaita-ācārya — koṭi-brahmāṇḍera kartā
Advaita Ācārya of millions of universes the creator
āra eka eka mūrtye brahmāṇḍera bhartā
and in one each form of a universe the maintainer

20 Advaita Ācārya is the creator of millions of universes, and in a separate form He maintains each universe.

*Advaita Prabhu, a limb (*aṅga*) or part (*aṁśa*) of Bhagavān —*

সেই নারায়ণের মুখ্য অঙ্গ, — অদ্বৈত ।
‘অঙ্গ’ শব্দে অংশ করি’ কহে ভাগবত ॥ ২১ ॥

sei nārāyaṇera mukhya aṅga, — advaita
of that Nārāyaṇa the principal limb Advaita
‘aṅga’ śabde aṁśa kari’ kahe bhāgavata
aṅga by the word portion (aṁśa) meaning says the Bhāgavata

21 Advaita is the principal limb (*aṅga*) of that Nārāyaṇa. The *Bhāgavatam* uses the word *aṅga* in the sense of *aṁśa*, a portion.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.67.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Canto 10, Chapter 14, verse 14)*

নারায়ণস্ত্বং ন হি সর্ব্বদেহিনা-
মাত্মাস্যধীশাখিললোকসাক্ষী ।
নারায়ণোঽঙ্গং নরভূজলায়না-
ত্তচ্চাপি সত্যং ন তবৈব মায়া ॥ ২২ ॥

nārāyaṇas tvaṁ na hi sarva-dehinām
Nārāyaṇa You not indeed of all embodied beings
ātmāsy adhīśākhila-loka-sākṣī
the Self You are O Lord of all worlds the witness
nārāyaṇo 'ṅgaṁ nara-bhū-jalāyanāt
Nārāyaṇa Your portion of Nara born the water as resting place
tac cāpi satyaṁ na tavaiva māyā
that and also true not Your indeed māyā

22 "O Lord, are You not Nārāyaṇa? You are the Self of all embodied beings and the witness of all the worlds. The one called Nārāyaṇa because His resting place is the water born of Nara is Your portion. And that portion too is real; it is not Your māyā." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.14.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.30.

*Though a limb or a part, He is beyond *māyā* —*

ঈশ্বরের 'অঙ্গ', অংশ — চিদানন্দময় ।
মায়ার সম্বন্ধ নাহি, এই শ্লোকে কয় ॥ ২৩ ॥

īśvarera 'aṅga', aṁśa — cid-ānanda-maya
of the Lord limb portion full of consciousness and bliss
māyāra sambandha nāhi, ei śloke kaya
with māyā connection there is not this verse says

23 This verse says that the Lord's limbs and portions are full of consciousness and bliss and have no connection with māyā.

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 3.69–70.

*Why He is called a limb (*aṅga*) and not a part (*aṁśa*) —*

‘অংশ’ না কহিয়া, কেনে কহ তাঁরে ‘অঙ্গ’ ।
‘অংশ’ হৈতে ‘অঙ্গ,’ যাতে হয় অন্তরঙ্গ ॥ ২৪ ॥

‘aṁśa’ nā kahiyā, kene kaha tāṅre ‘aṅga’
aṁśa not saying why call (you) Him aṅga
‘aṁśa’ haite ‘aṅga,’ yāte haya antaraṅga
than aṁśa aṅga (is better) since it is more intimate

24 Why call Him an *aṅga*, a limb, rather than an *aṁśa*, a portion? Because the word *aṅga* expresses greater intimacy than *aṁśa*.

Why the name “Advaita” is fitting —

মহাবিষ্ণুর অংশ — অদ্বৈত গুণধাম ।
ঈশ্বরে অভেদ, তেঞি ‘অদ্বৈত’ পূর্ণ নাম ॥ ২৫ ॥

mahā-viṣṇura aṁśa — advaita guṇa-dhāma
of Mahā-Viṣṇu a portion Advaita of good qualities the abode
īśvare abheda, teñi ‘advaita’ pūrṇa nāma
from the Lord non-different therefore Advaita the full name

25 Advaita, the abode of all good qualities, is a portion of Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is non-different from the Lord, and so His full name is Advaita, “non-dual.”

Why the name “Ācārya” is fitting —

পূর্ব্বে যৈছে কৈল সর্ব্ব বিশ্বের-সৃজন ।
অবতরি’ কৈল এবে ভক্তি-প্রবর্ত্তন ॥ ২৬ ॥

pūrve yaiche kaila sarva viśvera-sṛjana
before just as He did of all the universe creation
avatari’ kaila ebe bhakti-pravartana
having descended He did now of bhakti the establishing

26 Just as He once created the entire universe, so now He has descended and established the path of devotion.

In His descent as Advaita, His one work is to preach devotion to Kṛṣṇa —

জীব নিস্তারিল কৃষ্ণভক্তি করি' দান ।
গীতা-ভাগবতে কৈল ভক্তির ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ২৭ ॥

jīva nistārila kṛṣṇa-bhakti kari' dāna
the souls He delivered devotion to Kṛṣṇa making a gift
gītā-bhāgavate kaila bhaktira vyākhyāna
in the Gītā and the Bhāgavata He made of bhakti the explanation

27 He delivered the souls by giving them devotion to Kṛṣṇa, and He explained the *Bhagavad-gītā* and the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* in the light of bhakti.

ভক্তি-উপদেশ বিনু তাঁর নাহি কার্য্য ।
অতএব নাম হৈল 'অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য' ॥ ২৮ ॥

bhakti-upadeśa vinu tāṅra nāhi kārya
bhakti instruction except His there is not work
ataeva nāma haila 'advaita ācārya'
therefore the name became Advaita Ācārya

28 He has no work other than teaching bhakti; therefore His name became Advaita Ācārya.

Anubhāṣya.
Although Advaita Prabhu is the Viṣṇu-*tattva*, the one who is served, He has no other duty and no other conduct than this: to awaken in the *jīvas* the inclination to serve, for that is what securing their good means. Bhagavān Viṣṇu saw that if He displayed His pastimes only as the one who is served, the pleasure-seeking people of the world would imitate Him and become godless *kevalādvaita-vādīs* or *ahaṅgrahopāsakas*, who worship themselves as God. Therefore He manifested the pastimes of a servant; displaying this kind of ācāryaship is also one of His works. The Ācārya has no work other than conduct turned toward the service of Kṛṣṇa. He behaves as the servant of the One who is served — that is why He is the

ācārya; this is a particular pastime of a *naimittika-avatāra*. Wicked people try to defile the Ācārya's holy place and His dress and, instead of serving Bhagavān, launch into a wild dance (*tāṇḍava*) of gratifying their own senses. The Ācārya condemns this utterly.

বৈষ্ণবের গুরু তেঁহো জগতের আর্য্য ।
দুইনাম-মিলনে হৈল ‘অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্য’ ॥ ২৯ ॥

vaiṣṇavera guru teṅho jagatera ārya
of the Vaiṣṇavas the guru He of the world the most honored
dui-nāma-milane haila ‘advaita-ācārya’
of the two names by the union became Advaita Ācārya

29 He is the guru of the Vaiṣṇavas and the most honored person in the world. The union of the two names became “Advaita Ācārya.”

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Advaita Ācārya is the guru of the whole Vaiṣṇava world, and everyone honors Him. Following His lotus feet, the Vaiṣṇavas devoted to Bhagavān adopt His conduct and serve Hari.

Why the name “Kamalākṣa” is fitting —

কমল-নয়নের তেঁহো, যাতে ‘অঙ্গ’, ‘অংশ’ ।
‘কমলাক্ষ’ বলি’ ধরে নাম অবতংস ॥ ৩০ ॥

kamala-nayanera teṅho, yāte ‘aṅga’, ‘aṁśa’
of the Lotus-eyed He since limb portion
‘kamalākṣa’ bali’ dhare nāma avataṁsa
Kamalākṣa calling (Him) He bears the name as a crest jewel

30 Because He is a limb and portion of the lotus-eyed Lord, He is called Kamalākṣa, “the lotus-eyed,” and He wears that name like a crest jewel.

In Vaikuṇṭha the Vaiṣṇavas attain a form like that of Viṣṇu —

ঈশ্বরসারূপ্য পায় পারিষদগণ ।
চতুর্ভুজ, পীতবাস, যৈছে নারায়ণ ॥ ৩১ ॥

īśvara-sārūpya pāya pāriṣada-gaṇa
of the Lord likeness of form attain the associates
catur-bhuja, pīta-vāsa, yaiche nārāyaṇa
four-armed in yellow garments like Nārāyaṇa

31 The Lord's associates attain a form like His own (*sārūpya*): like Nārāyaṇa, they are four-armed and dressed in yellow.

The glory of Advaita Prabhu's qualities —

অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্য — ঈশ্বরের অংশবর্য্য ।
তাঁর তত্ত্ব-নাম-গুণ, সকলি আশ্চর্য্য ॥ ৩২ ॥

advaita-ācārya — īśvarera aṁśa-varya
Advaita Ācārya of the Lord the foremost portion
tāṅra tattva-nāma-guṇa, sakali āścarya
His truth name qualities all wonderful

32 Advaita Ācārya is the foremost portion of the Lord. His truth, His name and His qualities are all wonderful.

Advaita Prabhu calls Mahāprabhu down into the world —

যাঁহার তুলসীজলে, যাঁহার হুঙ্কারে ।
স্বগণ সহিতে চৈতন্যের অবতারে ॥ ৩৩ ॥

yāṅhāra tulasī-jale, yāṅhāra huṅkāre
by whose tulasī and water by whose roaring call
sva-gaṇa sahite caitanyera avatāre
His own associates together with Caitanya's descent

33 By His offerings of tulasī and water and by His roaring calls, Śrī Caitanya descended together with His associates.

যাঁর দ্বারা কৈল প্রভু কীর্ত্তন প্রচার ।
যাঁর দ্বারা কৈল প্রভু জগৎ নিস্তার ॥ ৩৪ ॥

yāṅra dvārā kaila prabhu kīrtana pracāra
through whom made the Lord of kīrtana the spreading
yāṅra dvārā kaila prabhu jagat nistāra
through whom made the Lord of the world the deliverance

34 Through Him the Lord spread the kīrtana, and through Him the Lord delivered the world.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.91, 95–108.

আচার্য্য গোসাঞির গুণ-মহিমা অপার ।
জীবকীট কোথায় পাইবেক তার পার ॥ ৩৫ ॥

ācārya gosāñira guṇa-mahimā apāra
of the Ācārya Gosāñi of the qualities the greatness boundless
jīva-kīṭa kothāya pāibeka tāra pāra
the jīva a worm where will find of it the limit

35 The qualities and greatness of Advaita Ācārya are boundless. How could a soul, a mere worm, ever find their limit?

One limb of Gaura is Advaita, another is Nitāi —

আচার্য্য গোসাঞি চৈতন্যের মুখ্য অঙ্গ ।
আর এক অঙ্গ তাঁর প্রভু নিত্যানন্দ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

ācārya gosāñi caitanyera mukhya aṅga
the Ācārya Gosāñi of Caitanya the principal limb
āra eka aṅga tāṅra prabhu nityānanda
another one limb His the Lord Nityānanda

36 Advaita Ācārya is the principal limb of Śrī Caitanya, and Lord Nityānanda is His other limb.

*The subsidiary limbs (*upāṅgas*) and weapons — the devotees headed by*

Śrīvāsa —

প্রভুর উপাঙ্গ — শ্রীবাসাদি ভক্তগণ ।
হস্তমুখনেত্র-অঙ্গ চক্রাদ্যস্ত্র-সম ॥ ৩৭ ॥

prabhura upāṅga — śrīvāsādi bhakta-gaṇa
of the Lord the sub-limbs Śrīvāsa and other devotees
hasta-mukha-netra-aṅga cakrādy-astra-sama
hands face eyes limbs the disc and other weapons like

37 The Lord's sub-limbs (*upāṅgas*) are Śrīvāsa and the other devotees. They are like His hands, face, eyes and other limbs, and like His disc and other weapons.

*With His limbs and subsidiary limbs Gaura preaches the holy name and *prema* —*

এসব লইয়া চৈতন্যপ্রভুর বিহার ।
এসব লইয়া করেন বাঞ্ছিত-প্রচার ॥ ৩৮ ॥

esaba laiyā caitanya-prabhura vihāra
with all these taking of Caitanya Prabhu the pastimes
esaba laiyā karena vāñchita-pracāra
with all these taking He makes of what He desired the spreading

38 With all of them Śrī Caitanya performs His pastimes, and with all of them He spreads what He desires to give.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.71–74.

Gaura regards Advaita Prabhu as His guru —

মাধবেন্দ্রপুরীর ইঁহো শিষ্য, এই জ্ঞানে ।
আচার্য্য-গোসাঞিরে প্রভু গুরু করি' মানে ॥ ৩৯ ॥

mādhavendrapurīra iṅho śiṣya, ei jñāne
of Mādhavendra Purī He a disciple in this awareness
ācārya-gosāñire prabhu guru kari' māne
the Ācārya Gosāñi the Lord as guru making regards

39 Knowing that Advaita is a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī, the Lord regards Him as His guru.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Advaita Prabhu was a disciple of Mādhavendra Purī, and His godbrother Īśvara Purī was Mahāprabhu's guru. Because of this relationship Mahāprabhu regards Ācārya Gosāñi as His "guru." In truth Śrī Caitanya Gosāñi is the Lord of all, and Advaita Ācārya Prabhu is His servant. In this relationship Advaita Prabhu regarded Himself as a "servant."

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Mādhavendra Purī is one of the gurus of the Śrī Madhvācārya-sampradāya. His disciples are Īśvara Purī and Śrī Advaita Prabhu. The branch of the Śrī Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas in the succession of Śrī Madhva is cited in the *Śrī Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā*, in the *Prameya-ratnāvalī* and in the book of Śrī Gopāla-guru Gosvāmī; it is also mentioned in the *Śrī Bhakti-ratnākara*. In the *Śrī Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* the branch of Śrī Madhva is described as follows: "The disciple of the Lord of Paravyoma was Brahmā, the master of the universe. His disciple became Nārada, and Nārada's disciple was Vyāsa. Śuka, having given up the path of (dry) knowledge, became the disciple of Vyāsa.[10] From Vyāsa the renowned Madhvācārya received initiation into the mantra of Kṛṣṇa. His disciple was the great-hearted Padmanābhācārya. His disciple was Narahari, and his disciple the *brāhmaṇa* Mādhava. His disciple was Akṣobhya, and his disciple Jayatīrtha. His disciple was Jñānasindhu, and his disciple Mahānidhi. His disciple was Vidyānidhi, and his servant Rājendra. His disciple was the sage Jayadharma; from among his followers came Śrīmad Viṣṇu Purī, the author of the *Bhakti-ratnāvalī*. The disciple of Jayadharma was Brahmaṇya Puruṣottama. His disciple was Vyāsatīrtha, who composed the *Viṣṇu-saṁhitā*. His disciple was the glorious Lakṣmīpati, the abode of *bhakti-rasa*. His disciple was Mādhavendra, who inaugurated this *dharma*. His disciple was the glorious *sannyāsī* Īśvara Purī. He whose very nature is the fruit of *śṛṅgāra* cultivated *śṛṅgāra*; Advaita cultivated both fruits, *dāsya* and *sakhya*. Gaura respectfully accepted Īśvara Purī [as guru] and flooded the whole world, both material and transcendental [with *prema*]."

Following worldly custom, Gaura treats Advaita like a guru —

লৌকিক-লীলাতে ধর্ম্মমর্য্যাদা-রক্ষণ ।
স্তুতি-ভক্ত্যে করে তাঁর চরণ-বন্দন ॥ ৪০ ॥

laukika-līlāte dharma-maryādā-rakṣaṇa
in His humanlike pastimes of dharma the bounds keeping
stuti-bhaktye kare tāṅra caraṇa-vandana
with praise with devotion He does His feet worship

40 In His humanlike pastimes He keeps the bounds of dharma, and with praise and devotion He worships Advaita's feet.

Advaita Prabhu regards Mahāprabhu as His Lord —

চৈতন্য-গোসাঞিকে আচার্য্য করে 'প্রভু' জ্ঞান ।
আপনাকে করেন তাঁর 'দাস' অভিমান ॥ ৪১ ॥

caitanya-gosāñike ācārya kare 'prabhu' jñāna
Caitanya Gosāñi the Ācārya holds as Master in awareness
āpanāke karena tāṅra 'dāsa' abhimāna
Himself He holds His servant in self-conception

41 Advaita Ācārya, however, regards Śrī Caitanya as His Master (*prabhu*) and thinks of Himself as His servant (*dāsa*).

*Thinking of Himself as Kṛṣṇa's servant, He preaches *bhakti* —*

সেই অভিমান-সুখে আপনা পাসরে ।
'কৃষ্ণদাস' হও — জীবে উপদেশ করে ॥ ৪২ ॥

sei abhimāna-sukhe āpanā pāsare
in that self-conception's joy Himself He forgets
'kṛṣṇa-dāsa' hao — jīve upadeśa kare
Kṛṣṇa's servants become to the souls instruction He gives

42 In the joy of that self-conception He forgets Himself and teaches all souls: "Become servants of Kṛṣṇa!"

Anubhāṣya.

Accepting the mood of a devotee, Mahā-Viṣṇu sets aside the awareness of His own true nature (*svarūpa*) and joyfully regards service to Bhagavān as His own duty to perform. That very joy of service loosens Mahā-Viṣṇu's awareness of His own nature (His sense of Himself as the enjoyer). By His own example He constantly inspires the *jīvas* to serve Kṛṣṇa. See verses 27–28.

In service to Kṛṣṇa lies the bliss of Vaikuṇṭha —

কৃষ্ণদাস-অভিমানে যে আনন্দসিন্ধু ।
কোটি-ব্রহ্মসুখ নহে তার এক বিন্দু ॥ ৪৩ ॥

kṛṣṇa-dāsa-abhimāne ye ānanda-sindhu
Kṛṣṇa's servant in the self-conception which of bliss the ocean
koṭi-brahma-sukha nahe tāra eka bindu
ten million of Brahman the happiness not is of it one drop

43 Such is the ocean of bliss in thinking oneself Kṛṣṇa's servant that the happiness of Brahman, multiplied ten million times, does not equal one drop of it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Brahma-sukha (the happiness of Brahman) is the happiness that comes with the thought of nondifference: "I am Brahman."[1]

Advaita and Nityānanda find happiness only in serving Gaura —

মুঞি যে চৈতন্যদাস, আর নিত্যানন্দ ।
দাস-ভাব-সম নহে অন্যত্র আনন্দ ॥ ৪৪ ॥

muñi ye caitanya-dāsa, āra nityānanda
I indeed Caitanya's servant and Nityānanda
dāsa-bhāva-sama nahe anyatra ānanda
of a servant's mood equal to there is not elsewhere bliss

44 [Advaita says:] "I am a servant of Caitanya, and so is Nityānanda." Nowhere is there bliss equal to the mood of a servant.

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 7.85, 97–98. In the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (*Pūrva-vibhāga*, First Wave): “Even if the bliss of Brahman were multiplied a *parārdha* times, it would not equal even an atom of the ocean of the happiness of *bhakti*.”[1] In the *Bhāvārtha-dīpikā*: “A fortunate few, sporting in great joy in the ocean of nectar of topics about You, hold the four goals of life no higher than a blade of grass. And those among them who do not desire even the subtle goal [of liberation] — *bhakti*, through *prema*, makes them people whose minds and very lives have been stolen. Devotees whose hearts have found bliss in serving the lotus feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa never desire liberation.” In the *Padma Purāṇa*, in the *Kārtika-māhātmya*: “O Lord, though You are the master of all who grant boons, I ask of You neither liberation, nor the highest limit of liberation, nor any other boon. O Lord, may only this form of Yours as a cowherd boy always appear in my mind! What do I want with anything else? As You, while bound, freed the two sons of Kuvera and made them devotees, so grant me too Your own *prema-bhakti*. O Dāmodara, I have no craving for liberation.”[12] In the *Śrī Nārāyaṇa-vyūha-stava* of the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra*: “O Lord of those who grant boons, I pray for neither *dharma*, nor *kāma*, nor *artha*, nor *mokṣa*. At Your lotus feet I desire only service.” “Viṣṇu wished again and again to grant him boons, yet he did not ask for liberation and chose *bhakti* alone — I bow to that Prahlāda.” “Though liberation came to him unsought from Viṣṇu, the son of Daśaratha, he did not want liberation without service — obeisances to that Hanumān.” In the words of Śrī Hanumān: “I do not long for the liberation that cuts the bonds of worldly existence, for in it [the awareness] ‘You are the Lord and I am the servant’ disappears.” In the *Nārada-pañcarātra*, in the *Jitante-stotra*: “I never have any desire for *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* or *mokṣa*. Grant that I may live at the foot of Your lotus feet. O upholder of the earth, I do not pray for *mokṣa*, *sālokya* or *sārūpya*. O most blessed one, true to Your vows, I desire only Your mercy.” In the hymn *Mukunda-mālā* of the emperor Kulaśekhara: “O Hari, I worship Your lotus feet not to be free of duality, not to escape the dreadful hell of Kumbhīpāka, and not to enjoy, in the garden of Nandana, beautiful women whose soft bodies are like creepers. I wish only, in whatever birth I take, to contemplate You in the chamber of my heart.” In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, see many verses: 3.25.36, 3.4.15, 3.25.34, 4.1.22, 4.9.10, 4.20.24, 5.14.43, 6.11.25, 6.17.28, 6.18.74, 7.6.25, 7.8.42, 8.3.20, 9.4.49, 9.21.12, 10.16.37, 10.87.21, 11.14.14, 11.20.34, 12.3.6 and others.

Examples showing that service to Kṛṣṇa is supreme: (1) Lakṣmī begs for service to Kṛṣṇa —

পরমপ্রেয়সী লক্ষ্মী হৃদয়ে বসতি ।
তেঁহো দাস্য-সুখ মাগে করিয়া মিনতি ॥ ৪৫ ॥

parama-preyasī lakṣmī hṛdaye vasati
supreme beloved Lakṣmī on (His) chest dwells
teṅho dāsya-sukha māge kariyā minati
she of service the happiness begs making entreaty

45 Lakṣmī, the Lord's most beloved, dwells on His chest, yet she too humbly begs for the happiness of serving Him.

(2) Viṣṇu's associates, and Brahmā, Śiva, the four Sanas, Nārada, Śuka and others also serve Kṛṣṇa —

দাস্য-ভাবে আনন্দিত পারিষদগণ ।
বিধি-ভব-নারদার-শুক-সনাতন ॥ ৪৬ ॥

dāsya-bhāve ānandita pāriṣada-gaṇa
in the mood of service blissful the associates
vidhi-bhava-nāradāra-śuka-sanātana
Brahmā Śiva Nārada and Śuka Sanātana

46 All the Lord's associates are blissful in the mood of service: Brahmā, Śiva, Nārada, Śuka, Sanātana Kumāra and others.

(3) Nitāi, mad in the service of Gaura —

নিত্যানন্দ অবধূত সবাতে আগল ।
চৈতন্যের দাস্য-প্রেমে হইলা পাগল ॥ ৪৭ ॥

nityānanda avadhūta sabāte āgala
Nityānanda the Avadhūta among all foremost
caitanyera dāsya-preme hailā pāgala
in Caitanya's love of service became mad

47 Nityānanda Avadhūta, foremost among them all, became mad with love in the service of Śrī Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Āgala means foremost, the first.

*(4) Śrīvāsa and the other great souls (*mahājanas*) — all serve Gaura —*

শ্রীবাস, হরিদাস, রামদাস, গদাধর ।
মুরারি, মুকুন্দ, চন্দ্রশেখর, বক্রেশ্বর ॥ ৪৮ ॥

এসব পণ্ডিতলোক পরম-মহত্ত্ব ।
চৈতন্যের দাস্যে সবায় করয়ে উন্মত্ত ॥ ৪৯ ॥

śrīvāsa, haridāsa, rāmadāsa, gadādhara
Śrīvāsa Haridāsa Rāmadāsa Gadādhara
murāri, mukunda, candraśekhara, vakreśvara
Murāri Mukunda Candraśekhara Vakreśvara
esaba paṇḍita-loka parama-mahattva
all these learned men of the highest greatness
caitanyera dāsye sabāya karaye unmatta
Caitanya's service all makes mad

48–49 Śrīvāsa, Haridāsa, Rāmadāsa, Gadādhara, Murāri, Mukunda, Candraśekhara and Vakreśvara are learned men of the highest greatness, yet service to Śrī Caitanya makes them all mad with love.

Being servants of Gaura themselves, they teach only service to Gaura —

এইমত গায়, নাচে, করে অট্টহাস ।
লোকে উপদেশে, — 'হও চৈতন্যের দাস' ॥ ৫০ ॥

ei mata gāya, nāce, kare aṭṭahāsa
thus they sing dance make loud laughter
loke upadeśe, — 'hao caitanyera dāsa'
the people they teach become Caitanya's servants

50 So they sing, dance and laugh aloud, and they teach everyone: “Become servants of Śrī Caitanya!”

চৈতন্যগোসাঞি মোরে করে গুরু-জ্ঞান ।
তথাপিহ মোর হয় ‘দাস’ অভিমান ॥ ৫১ ॥

caitanyagosāñi more kare guru-jñāna
Caitanya Gosāñi Me holds as guru
tathāpiha mora haya ‘dāsa’ abhimāna
even so My there is servant self-conception

51 [Advaita thinks:] “Śrī Caitanya regards Me as His guru, yet I still feel Myself to be His servant.”

The power of love for Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণপ্রেমের এই এক অপূর্ব্ব প্রভাব ।
গুরু-সম-লঘুকে করায় দাস্যভাব ॥ ৫২ ॥

kṛṣṇa-premera ei eka apūrva prabhāva
of love for Kṛṣṇa this one unprecedented power
guru-sama-laghuke karāya dāsya-bhāva
elders equals juniors it makes have the servant's mood

52 This is one unprecedented power of love for Kṛṣṇa: it gives the mood of a servant to elders, equals and juniors alike.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Guru: the elders, who abide in the *rasa* of parental love (*vātsalya*); *sama*: the equals (who abide in the *rasa* of friendship, *sakhya*); *laghu*: the younger ones. Love for Kṛṣṇa gives the mood of a servant to all three. Therefore all of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's elders, equals and juniors are His servants.

Anubhāṣya.

The Lord's elders in this world serve Him without knowing it. A mind dominated by majesty, or the path of reverent propriety (*maryādā-mārga*), often cannot grasp this. That is why service to Nārāyaṇa lacks the wonder found in love for Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa's elders accept the position of elders only to become established in

the highest service — and so they serve Him. Service by those related to the Lord as equals or juniors can be grasped even by a mind dominated by majesty; but the strength of a servant's mood in one who regards himself as an elder exists only in service to Kṛṣṇa. To be inclined to serve with one's whole being and to long for service without measure is possible only toward Kṛṣṇa, whom all serve. Nārāyaṇa has many servants, equals and juniors; but Kṛṣṇa's elders, displaying a wondrous power, serve Him wholly. Kṛṣṇa's elders, His equals and those He embraces with tender affection — all three kinds of [associates], filled with love for Him, serve Kṛṣṇa. This is the wondrous power of *prema*.

Evidence from the experience of perfected souls —

ইহার প্রমাণ শুন শাস্ত্রের ব্যাখ্যান ।
মহদনুভব যাতে সুদৃঢ় প্রমাণ ॥ ৫৩ ॥

ihāra pramāṇa śuna śāstrera vyākhyāna
of this the proof hear of the scriptures the explanation
mahad-anubhava yāte sudṛḍha pramāṇa
of the great the experience in which firm proof

53 Hear the proof of this in the explanation of the scriptures, where the experience of great souls stands as firm proof.

*(5) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even in the parental love (*vātsalya-rasa*) of Nanda Mahārāja —*

অন্যের কা কথা, ব্রজে নন্দ মহাশয় ।
তাঁর সম ‘গুরু’ কৃষ্ণের আর কেহ নয় ॥ ৫৪ ॥

শুদ্ধবাৎসল্যে ঈশ্বর-জ্ঞান নাহি তাঁর ।
তাঁহাকেই প্রেমে করায় দাস্য-অনুকার ॥ ৫৫ ॥

anyera kā kathā, vraje nanda mahāśaya
of others what talk in Vraja Nanda the great soul
tāṅra sama 'guru' kṛṣṇera āra keha naya
his equal elder of Kṛṣṇa other anyone is not
śuddha-vātsalye īśvara-jñāna nāhi tāṅra
in pure parental love of God awareness not his
tāṅhākei preme karāya dāsya-anukāra
him even love makes service imitate

54–55 What to speak of others? In Vraja no one is so much Kṛṣṇa's elder (*guru*) as the noble Nanda. In his pure parental love (*vātsalya*) he has no awareness that Kṛṣṇa is God, yet love moves even him to take on the mood of a servant.

তেঁহো রতি-মতি মাগে কৃষ্ণের চরণে ।
তাহার শ্রীমুখবাণী তাহাতে প্রমাণে ॥ ৫৬ ॥

teṅho rati-mati māge kṛṣṇera caraṇe
he love devotion begs of Kṛṣṇa at the feet
tāhāra śrī-mukha-vāṇī tāhāte pramāṇe
his holy mouth's words of that the proof

56 He too prays for love and devotion at Kṛṣṇa's feet, and the words from his own lips prove it.

শুন উদ্ধব, সত্য, কৃষ্ণ, — আমার তনয় ।
তেঁহো ঈশ্বর — হেন যদি তোমার মনে লয় ॥ ৫৭ ॥

তথাপি তাঁহাতে রহু মোর মনোবৃত্তি ।
তোমার ঈশ্বর-কৃষ্ণে হউক মোর মতি ॥ ৫৮ ॥

śuna uddhava, satya, kṛṣṇa, — āmāra tanaya
hear Uddhava truly Kṛṣṇa my son
teṅho īśvara — hena yadi tomāra mane laya
He God so if your mind takes it
tathāpi tāṅhāte rahu mora mano-vṛtti
still on Him may remain my mind's movements
tomāra īśvara-kṛṣṇe hauka mora mati
on your God Kṛṣṇa may be my devotion

57–58 "Listen, Uddhava: truly, Kṛṣṇa is my son. If you think He is God, so be it. Still, may every movement of my mind rest on Him, and may my heart be fixed on Kṛṣṇa, your God."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Uddhava, even if Kṛṣṇa is regarded as Īśvara, let my mind still rest in that Kṛṣṇa.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.47.66–67)*

মনসো বৃত্তয়ো নঃ স্যুঃ কৃষ্ণপাদাম্বুজাশ্রয়াঃ ৷
বাচোঽভিধায়িনীর্নাম্নাং কায়স্তৎপ্রহ্বণাদিষু ॥ ৫৯ ॥

manaso vṛttayo naḥ syuḥ
of the mind the movements our may be
kṛṣṇa-pādāmbujāśrayāḥ
Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet taking shelter of
vāco 'bhidhāyinīr nāmnām
the words uttering of the names
kāyas tat-prahvaṇādiṣu
the body in bowing to Him and so on

59 "May our minds take shelter of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, may our words speak His names, and may our bodies bow down to Him and serve Him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.47.66)

Anubhāṣya.
After meeting the residents of Vraja, Uddhava took leave of them and was about to return to Dvārakā.[13] Then Nanda and the other cowherd men, full of love for Śrī Kṛṣṇa, speak to Uddhava:

naḥ (our) **manasaḥ vṛttayaḥ** (workings of the mind) **kṛṣṇa-pādāmbujāśrayāḥ** (taking shelter of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet) **syuḥ** (may be). [Our] **vācaḥ** (words) **tu nāmnām** (His names) **abhidhāyinīḥ** (uttering — may they be devoted to *kīrtana*), **kāyaḥ** (the body) **tat-prahvaṇādiṣu** (in bowing to Him, Kṛṣṇa, and so on) **astu** (may be engaged).

কর্ম্মভির্ভ্রাম্যমাণানাং যত্র ক্বাপীশ্বরেচ্ছয়া ।
মঙ্গলাচরিতৈর্দানৈ রতির্নঃ কৃষ্ণ ঈশ্বরে ॥ ৬০ ॥

karmabhir bhrāmyamāṇānāṁ
by karma being made to wander
yatra kvāpīśvarecchayā
wherever by the Lord's will
maṅgalācaritair dānai
by auspicious deeds by gifts
ratir naḥ kṛṣṇa īśvare
love our for Kṛṣṇa the Lord (may be)

60 "Wherever we may wander by the Lord's will, driven by our karma, may our good deeds and our gifts bring us love for Kṛṣṇa, the Lord." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.47.67)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Nanda said: "O Uddhava, may all the workings of our minds take shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet, may our words sing His names, and may our bodies bow down to Him. Whatever our condition may be by the will of Īśvara, according to the fruits of our karma, may charity and other auspicious deeds increase our love (*rati*) for Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Person."

Anubhāṣya.
karmabhiḥ (by deeds — sinful, pious and others that bear fruit) **īśvarecchayā** (by the will of Īśvara) **yatra kvāpi** (wherever it may be) **bhrāmyamāṇānām** (wandering — being born among the eighty-four [lakhs of] species) **naḥ** (our) **maṅgalācaritaiḥ dānaiḥ** (by the auspicious deeds that arise from them) **īśvare** (for Bhagavān) **kṛṣṇe** (Kṛṣṇa) **ratiḥ** (attachment) **astu** (may there be).

*(6) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even in the friendship (*sakhya-rasa*) of the friends of Vraja —*

শ্রীদামাদি ব্রজে যত সখার নিচয় ।
ঐশ্বর্য্য-জ্ঞান-হীন, কেবল-সখ্যময় ॥ ৬১ ॥

śrīdāmādi vraje yata sakhāra nicaya
Śrīdāmā and others in Vraja all of friends the host
aiśvarya-jñāna-hīna, kevala-sakhya-maya
of majesty awareness without purely of friendship full

61 In Vraja, Śrīdāmā and all of Kṛṣṇa's other friends know nothing of His majesty; they are filled with pure friendship (*sakhya*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sakhya is of two kinds: “with awareness of majesty” and *kevala*, that is, “unmixed,” *sakhya*. Śrīdāmā and the other friends in Vraja have *kevala sakhya*: they do not know Kṛṣṇa's majesty.

কৃষ্ণসঙ্গে যুদ্ধ করে, স্কন্ধে আরোহণ ।
তারা দাস্যভাবে করে চরণ-সেবন ॥ ৬২ ॥

kṛṣṇa-saṅge yuddha kare, skandhe ārohaṇa
with Kṛṣṇa fighting they do on His shoulders climbing
tārā dāsya-bhāve kare caraṇa-sevana
they in the mood of service render to His feet service

62 They wrestle with Kṛṣṇa and climb onto His shoulders, yet in the mood of servants they serve His feet.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.15.17)*

পাদসম্বাহনং চক্রুঃ কেচিত্তস্য মহাত্মনঃ ।
অপরে হতপাপ্মানো ব্যজনৈঃ সমবীজয়ন্ ॥ ৬৩ ॥

pāda-saṁvāhanaṁ cakruḥ
of the feet massaging did
kecit tasya mahātmanaḥ
some of Him the great-hearted
apare hata-pāpmāno
others whose sins were destroyed
vyajanaiḥ samavījayan
with fans fanned (Him)

63 "Some massaged the feet of the great-hearted Lord, and others, whose sins had been destroyed, fanned Him with fans." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.15.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When Kṛṣṇa lay down, one friend began to massage His feet, and another, in a mood of pure friendship, to fan Him with a fan made of leaves.

Anubhāṣya.
Before the demon Dhenuka was killed in Tālavana, the cowherd boys played with one another in this way, together with Rāma and Kṛṣṇa:

hata-pāpmānaḥ (freed of impurity) **kecit** (some cowherd boys) **mahātmanaḥ** (of Bhagavān) **tasya** (of Him, Kṛṣṇa) **pāda-saṁvāhanam** (massaging of the feet) **cakruḥ** (did); **apare** (other cowherd boys) **vyajanaiḥ** (with fans) **samavījayan** (fanned properly).

*(7) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even in the conjugal love (*madhura-rasa*) of the gopīs of Vraja —*

কৃষ্ণের প্রেয়সী ব্রজে যত গোপীগণ ।
যাঁর পদধূলি করে উদ্ধব প্রার্থন ॥ ৬৪ ॥

যাঁ-সবার উপরে কৃষ্ণের প্রিয় নাহি আন ।
তাঁহারা আপনাকে করে দাসী-অভিমান ॥ ৬৫ ॥

kṛṣṇera preyasī vraje yata gopī-gaṇa
Kṛṣṇa's beloveds in Vraja all the gopīs
yāṅra pada-dhūli kare uddhava prārthana
whose feet's dust makes Uddhava prayer (for)
yāṅ-sabāra upare kṛṣṇera priya nāhi āna
than all of them above to Kṛṣṇa dear is not another
tāṅhārā āpanāke kare dāsī-abhimāna
they themselves hold maidservant in self-conception

64–65 Kṛṣṇa's beloveds in Vraja, the gopīs, the dust of whose feet Uddhava prays for and than whom no one is dearer to Kṛṣṇa, think of themselves as His maidservants.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.31.6)*

ব্রজজনার্ত্তিহন্ বীর যোষিতাং
নিজ-জনস্ময়ধ্বংসনস্মিত ৷
ভজ সখে ভবৎ কিঙ্করীঃ স্ম নো
জলরুহাননং চারু দর্শয় ॥ ৬৬ ॥

vraja-janārti-han vīra yoṣitāṁ
of Vraja's people the pain O destroyer O hero of women
nija-janasmaya-dhvaṁsana-smita
of Your own people the pride destroying whose smile
bhaja sakhe bhavat kiṅkarīḥ sma no
accept O friend Your maidservants indeed us
jala-ruhānanaṁ cāru darśaya
the lotus face lovely show

66 "O You who take away the suffering of the people of Vraja! O hero of women, whose smile destroys the pride of Your own people! O friend, accept us, Your maidservants, and show us Your lovely lotus face." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.31.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O You who destroy the sorrows of Vraja! O supreme hero among women! O You whose gentle smile dispels the pride of Your own people![2] O friend, we are Your

maidservants: show us Your lotus face.

Anubhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa disappeared during the *rāsa* dance, the gopīs, searching for Him, sang:

he vraja-janārti-han (O You who destroy the pain of separation of those full of love for Kṛṣṇa), **vīra** (O You whose form is magnanimous), **nija-jana-smaya-dhvaṁsana-smita** (O You whose smile destroys the *smaya*, that is, the pride, of Your own people, the embodiments of *rasa*), **sakhe** (O friend), **sma** (surely) **bhavat-kiṅkarīḥ naḥ** (us, Your maidservants) **bhaja** (stay with us); **cāru** (enchanting) **jala-ruhānanam** (lotus face) **ca yoṣitām** (to us women, the gopīs) **darśaya** (show).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.47.21)*

অপি বত মধুপুর্য্যামার্য্যপুত্রোঽধুনাস্তে
স্মরতি স পিতৃগেহান্ সৌম্য বন্ধূংশ্চ গোপান্ ।
ক্বচিদপি স কথাং নঃ কিঙ্করিণাং গৃণীতে
ভুজমগুরুসুগন্ধং মূর্ধ্ন্যধাস্যৎ কদা নু ॥ ৬৭ ॥

api bata madhu-puryām ārya-putro 'dhunāste
is it alas in Madhupurī the noble one's son now stays
smarati sa pitṛ-gehān saumya bandhūṁś ca gopān
remembers He father's home O gentle one friends and cowherds
kvacid api sa kathāṁ naḥ kiṅkariṇāṁ gṛṇīte
ever even He talk of us maidservants speaks
bhujam aguru-sugandhaṁ mūrdhny adhāsyat kadā nu
His arm with aguru fragrant on the head will place when indeed

67 "Alas, does the son of the noble Nanda now live in Madhupurī? O gentle one, does He remember His father's home, His friends and the cowherds? Does He ever speak of us, His maidservants? When will He place on our heads His arm, fragrant with aguru?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.47.21)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

How sad that our *ārya-putra* now lives in the city of Mathurā! O Uddhava, does He remember the home of His father Nanda and His cowherd friends? Does He

ever speak of us, His maidservants? Ah, will He ever again place on our heads His hand, fragrant like *aguru*?

Anubhāṣya.

When Uddhava came to Vraja, Śrīmatī, addressing a bee, speaks *citra-jalpa* (varied talk):

he saumya (O gentle one), **api bata ārya-putraḥ** (the son of Nanda) **adhunā** (now) **madhu-puryām** (in Mathurā) **āste** (does He live happily)? **saḥ pitṛ-gehān** (together with His parents, Nanda and Yaśodā, and with the homes) **bandhūn** (the relatives — Parjanya, Varīyasī, Upananda, Abhinanda, Sannanda, Nandana, Rohiṇī, Sānandā, Nandinī, Kaṇḍava, Daṇḍava and others), **gopān** (the cowherd boys — Subala, Arjuna, Gandharva, Vasanta, Śrīdāmā, Sudāmā, Ujjvala, Kokila, Sanandana, Vidagdha and others) **ca kiṁ smarati** (does He remember)? **kvacit** (ever) **api kiṅkarīṇām** (of the maidservants — Lalitā, Viśākhā, Citrā, Campakalatā, Tuṅgavidyā, Indulekhā, Raṅgadevī, Sudevī, Kalāvatī, Śubhāṅgadā, Hiraṇyāṅgī, Ratnalekhā, Śikhāvatī, Kandarpa-mañjarī, Phullakalikā, Anaṅga-mañjarī, Puṇḍarīkā, Sītākhaṇḍī, Cārucaṇḍī, Sadaṇḍikā, Kuṇṭhitā, Kalakaṇṭhī, Romaci, Mecakā, Haridrābhā, Haricchelā, Vitaṇḍikā, Līlāvatī, Sādhikā, Candrikā, Mādhavī, Vijayā, Nandā, Gaurī, Sudhāmukhī, Vṛndā, Kaumudī, Ratnabhavā, Ratnaprabhā and others) **naḥ** (of us — Śrīmatī, the daughter of Vṛṣabhānu, Gāndharvikā) **kathām** (talk) **saḥ gṛṇīte** (does He speak with His own lips)? **kadā nu** (when) **aguru-sugandham** (more fragrant even than *aguru*) **bhujam** (His arm) **mūrdhni** (on our heads) **adhāsyat** (will He place)?

(8) More than that, even Śrī Rādhā Herself serves Kṛṣṇa —

তাঁ-সবার কথা রহু, — শ্রীমতী রাধিকা ।
সবা হৈতে সকলাংশে পরম-অধিকা ॥ ৬৮ ॥

তেঁহো যাঁর দাসী হৈঞা সেবেন চরণ ।
যাঁর প্রেমগুণে কৃষ্ণ বদ্ধ অনুক্ষণ ॥ ৬৯ ॥

tāṅ-sabāra kathā rahu, — śrīmatī rādhikā
of them all the talk let it be Śrīmatī Rādhikā
sabā haite sakalāṁśe parama-adhikā
than all in every respect supremely greater
teṅho yāṅra dāsī haiñā sevena caraṇa
She His maidservant becoming serves the feet
yāṅra prema-guṇe kṛṣṇa baddha anukṣaṇa
by whose love's qualities Kṛṣṇa bound at every moment

68–69 Let alone the other gopīs: Śrīmatī Rādhikā, who surpasses them all in every respect and whose love and virtues keep Kṛṣṇa bound at every moment, serves His feet as His maidservant.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.30.39)*

হা নাথ রমণ প্রেষ্ঠ ক্বাসি ক্বাসি মহাভুজ ।
দাস্যাস্তে কৃপণায়া মে সখে দর্শয় সন্নিধিম্ ॥ ৭০ ॥

hā nātha ramaṇa preṣṭha
O Master Lover Dearest
kvāsi kvāsi mahā-bhuja
where are You where are You O mighty-armed one
dāsyās te kṛpaṇāyā me
to Your maidservant Your wretched to Me
sakhe darśaya sannidhim
O friend show Your presence

70 "O Master! O Lover! O Dearest! Where are You, where are You, O mighty-armed one? O friend, show Yourself to Me, Your wretched maidservant!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.30.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
O Lord! O lover! O dearest! O mighty-armed one! I am Your most wretched maidservant: bring me near to You!

Anubhāṣya.
During the *rāsa* dance Kṛṣṇa left the other gopīs and disappeared with Śrīmatī Rādhikā alone. Seeing the other gopīs lament in separation from Kṛṣṇa, Śrīmatī, in

a fit of pride, said that She could walk no further and told Kṛṣṇa to carry Her. Then Kṛṣṇa disappeared, and Śrīmatī lamented:

hā nātha, **ramaṇa**, **preṣṭha** (the best of all), **kvāsi** ([where are] You), **kvāsi**? **he sakhe**, **kṛpaṇāyāḥ** (tormented by separation from You) **dīnāyāḥ te** (Your) **dāsyāḥ** (to the maidservant, that is, to me) **sannidhim** (Your nearness) **darśaya** (reveal).

দ্বারকাতে রুক্মিণ্যাদি যতেক মহিষী ।
তাঁহারাও আপনাকে মানে কৃষ্ণদাসী ॥ ৭১ ॥

dvārakāte rukmiṇyādi yateka mahiṣī
in Dvārakā Rukmiṇī and the other all queens
tāṅhārāo āpanāke māne kṛṣṇa-dāsī
they also themselves consider Kṛṣṇa's maidservants

71 In Dvārakā, Rukmiṇī and all the other queens also consider themselves Kṛṣṇa's maidservants.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.83.11)*

তপশ্চরন্তীমাজ্ঞায় স্বপাদস্পর্শনাশয়া ।
সখ্যোপেত্যাগ্রহীৎ পাণিং সাহং তদ্গৃহমার্জ্জনী ॥ ৭২ ॥

tapaś carantīm ājñāya
austerities performing knowing (me)
sva-pāda-sparśanāśayā
His own feet touching with the desire
sakhyopetyāgrahīt pāṇiṁ
with His friend coming He took my hand
sāhaṁ tad-gṛha-mārjanī
she I His house sweeper

72 "Knowing that I was performing austerities in the hope of touching His feet, He came with His friend Arjuna and took my hand. I am that same woman, the one who sweeps His house." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.83.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I was performing austerities, longing to touch Śrī Kṛṣṇa's feet. In His mercy Kṛṣṇa came with His friend and took my hand in marriage. Since then I have been His maidservant who sweeps His house.

Anubhāṣya.

When the women of the Yadu and Kuru dynasties gathered together at Samanta-pañcaka, Kṛṣṇa's queen Kālindī, in a conversation about Kṛṣṇa, said to Draupadī:

sva-pāda-sparśanāśayā (with the hope of touching the feet of Him, Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **tapaś carantīm mā** (me), who was performing austerities, **ājñāya** (knowing), **saḥ kṛṣṇaḥ sakhyā** (with Arjuna) **saha upetya** (coming near) **pāṇim agrahīt**; **sā** (I) am **tat** (His) **gṛha-mārjanī** (maidservant).

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.83.39)*

আত্মারামস্য তস্যেমা বয়ং বৈ গৃহদাসিকাঃ ৷
সর্ব্বসঙ্গনিবৃত্ত্যাদ্ধা তপসা চ বভূবিম ॥ ৭৩ ॥

ātmārāmasya tasyemā
of the self-satisfied of Him these
vayaṁ vai gṛha-dāsikāḥ
we indeed housemaids
sarva-saṅga-nivṛttyāddhā
of all attachments by giving up directly
tapasā ca babhūvima
by austerity and we have become

73 "By giving up all attachments and by austerity, we have become the housemaids of Him who delights in Himself." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.83.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Through many austerities, giving up all attachment, we have attained the position of maidservants in the house of this Person, who delights in Himself (*ātmārāma*).

Anubhāṣya.

At the same time, in the same conversation, Kṛṣṇa's queen Lakṣmaṇā says to Draupadī:

imāḥ vayam (we, the queens) **sarva-saṅga-nivṛttyā** (by withdrawing, through indifference, from attachment to everything — happiness, wealth, sons and so on, or the four goals of life including *mokṣa*) **tapasā** (by the service of maidservants) **ātmārāmasya tasya** (of Him, Kṛṣṇa) **addhā** (directly) **gṛha-dāsikāḥ babhūvima** (have become).

*(10) Service to Kṛṣṇa — even by Balarāma, the *svayaṁ-prakāśa* —*

আনের কি কথা, বলদেব মহাশয়।
যাঁর ভাব — শুদ্ধসখ্য-বাৎসল্যাদিময় ॥ ৭৪ ॥

ānera ki kathā, baladeva mahāśaya
of others what talk Baladeva the great one
yāṅra bhāva — śuddha-sakhya-vātsalyādi-maya
whose mood of pure friendship parental love and so on full

74 What to speak of others? Consider the great Baladeva, whose mood is full of pure friendship, parental affection and the like.

Anubhāṣya.

Baladeva is the elder brother and so worthy of honor, yet He knows Himself only as the servant of His younger brother Kṛṣṇa. In Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha the *catur-vyūha* is only a chamber (*prakoṣṭha*) of this same Baladeva, the *svayaṁ-prakāśa*: this is the supreme majesty of the all-powerful Parameśvara. On the path of reverence (*maryādā-mārga*) even such an exalted, supreme position is established in service to Kṛṣṇa. Therefore no being — neither in Goloka and Vaikuṇṭha, nor in the countless universes, nor within them — is able to enjoy Kṛṣṇa or make Him its servant. Everyone other than Kṛṣṇa excels others exactly to the degree that he is inclined to serve Kṛṣṇa. And to the degree that a being has given up service to Kṛṣṇa and turned away from Him, to that degree he has invited misfortune. In the material world the urge to enjoy Kṛṣṇa, or to think oneself Kṛṣṇa's equal and enjoy as He does, is the root mantra of the nondevotees; yet by their true nature all who take shelter of Kṛṣṇa are eternally engaged in serving Bhagavān. It is aversion to serving Kṛṣṇa that makes the *jīva* like one dead. When knowledge of Kṛṣṇa awakens, the inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa is seen in every *jīva*, to a greater or lesser degree.

তেঁহো আপনাকে করেন দাস-ভাবনা ।
কৃষ্ণদাস-ভাব বিনু আছে কোন জনা ॥ ৭৫ ॥

teṅho āpanāke karena dāsa-bhāvanā
He Himself makes servant conception
kṛṣṇa-dāsa-bhāva vinu āche kona janā
Kṛṣṇa's servant mood without is there which person

75 Even He thinks of Himself as a servant. Who is there without the mood of a servant of Kṛṣṇa?

(11) Ananta in the form of Śeṣa serves Kṛṣṇa in ten bodies —

সহস্র-বদনে যেঁহো শেষ-সঙ্কর্ষণ ।
দশ দেহ ধরি' করে কৃষ্ণের সেবন ॥ ৭৬ ॥

sahasra-vadane yeṅho śeṣa-saṅkarṣaṇa
with a thousand mouths who Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa
daśa deha dhari' kare kṛṣṇera sevana
ten bodies assuming renders to Kṛṣṇa service

76 Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa, who has a thousand mouths, assumes ten bodies to serve Kṛṣṇa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The ten bodies are the umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, ornaments, pleasure garden, dwelling, sacred thread and throne.

(12) Śiva's service to Kṛṣṇa —

অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে রুদ্র — সদাশিবের অংশ ।
গুণাবতার তেঁহো, সর্ব্বদেব-অবতংস ॥ ৭৭ ॥

ananta brahmāṇḍe rudra — sadāśivera aṁśa
in unlimited universes Rudra of Sadāśiva a portion
guṇāvatāra teṅho, sarva-deva-avataṁsa
the guṇa-avatāra he of all gods the crown

77 In the unlimited universes Rudra is a portion of Sadāśiva. He is the *guṇa-avatāra* and the crown of all the gods.

তেঁহো করেন কৃষ্ণের দাস্য-প্রত্যাশ ।
নিরন্তর কহে শিব, 'মুঞি কৃষ্ণদাস' ॥ ৭৮ ॥

teṅho karena kṛṣṇera dāsya-pratyāśa
he makes of Kṛṣṇa's service the hope
nirantara kahe śiva, 'muñi kṛṣṇa-dāsa'
constantly says Śiva I Kṛṣṇa's servant

78 He too longs to serve Kṛṣṇa. Śiva constantly says, "I am Kṛṣṇa's servant."

Anubhāṣya.

Rudra and Sadāśiva. In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, in the description of the *guṇa-avatāras* (verses 18–24), it is said of Rudra: "He is said to be eleven *vyūhas* and eight bodies; usually he has five faces, three eyes and ten arms. Sometimes Hara, like Brahmā (Vidhi), is said to be a particular *jīva*. But this should be understood as in the case of Śeṣa, for he is glorified as a part [of the Lord]. Hara is the abode of the Puruṣa and so is in essence almost *nirguṇa*; but because of his connection with *tamas* everyone sees him here as subject to change. As the Tenth Canto says (10.88.3): 'Śiva is always joined with his potency, has three marks and is covered by the *guṇas*.' As the *Brahma-saṁhitā* says (5.45): 'As milk, joined with a particular transforming agent, becomes yogurt, yet [the yogurt] is not different from its cause, so He who for a particular task takes the form of Śambhu — Govinda, the original Person, Him I worship.' Sometimes he is born from the forehead of Brahmā (Vidhi), sometimes from the forehead of the Lord of Kamalā; and at the end of a *kalpa* Kālāgni-Rudra appears from Saṅkarṣaṇa as well. His form called Sadāśiva is free from even a trace of *tamas*. He is the cause of all and a part of the Lord Himself. It is he who is described in the *Vāyu Purāṇa* and others as [dwelling] in Śivaloka. So too in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*, where the original Śiva is spoken of (5.8): 'Niyati is Ramā-devī, His beloved, obedient to Him. His *liṅga* is the eternal Bhagavān Śambhu, whose form is light. And she who is the *yoni* is the *aparā śakti*,' and so on."

Śrī Rudra has eleven *vyūhas*: Ajaikapāt, Ahirbudhnya, Virūpākṣa, Raivata, Hara, Bahurūpa, Tryambaka the best of the gods, Sāvitra, Jayanta, Pinākī and Aparājita;

and eight forms (*mūrtis*): earth, water, fire, air, ether, the sun, the moon and the performer of the *soma* sacrifice. Among them Rudra is usually five-faced, three-eyed and ten-armed. In some places Rudra, like Vidhi (Brahmā), is glorified as “a particular *jīva*.” But since he is also glorified as a part of Bhagavān, this must be reconciled as in the case of “Śeṣa”: Śiva, the *svāṁśa* (the Lord's own part), belongs to the category of Īśvara, while Rudra the destroyer is a *vibhinnāṁśa*, a *jīva*. Hara is an avatāra of Bhagavān and by nature the Puruṣa, so in truth he is *nirguṇa*; but because of his connection with the mode of darkness, to ordinary people who do not know the truth he seems at first sight to be subject to change. As the Tenth Canto says: “Rudra is always joined with *prakṛti*, the state of equilibrium of the *guṇas*; when the *guṇas* are agitated, he is joined with the three *guṇas* and covered by them from afar.” As the *Brahma-saṁhitā* says: “Milk, joined with a particular transforming agent, turns into yogurt, yet that yogurt is never a thing separate from its cause, the milk. So too He who descends in the form of Rudra for the sake of destruction — the original Person Govinda, Him I worship.” In one *kalpa* Rudra is born from the forehead of Brahmā (Vidhi), in another from the forehead of Viṣṇu. At the end of a *kalpa* Kālāgni-Rudra is born from Saṅkarṣaṇa as well. The *Vāyu Purāṇa* and others describe a form of Śiva named Sadāśiva in Śivaloka, which lies within Vaikuṇṭha: He is the cause of all and has no connection with the mode of darkness. This Sadāśiva is a *vilāsa* of Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself. As the *Brahma-saṁhitā* says of the original Śiva: “The unfailing Ramā-devī, inseparable from Bhagavān, part of His own nature and obedient to Him, is His beloved; the eternal Bhagavān Śambhu, whose form is light, is a particular part of that *svayaṁ-rūpa*. She who is the *yoni*, the part that serves as the womb — Mahāmāyā, the source of the *mahat-tattva* and the other [elements] — is the *aparā*, the lower potency made of the three *guṇas*, called *pradhāna*,” and so on.

Śrī Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa [comments as follows]. Because particular statements [of scripture] are found, [the author] speaks [this verse] to show that Rudra too is of two kinds.[14] First he speaks of the one who in the verse beginning *sattvaṁ rajaḥ* (*Bhāgavatam* 1.2.23) is named as belonging to the category of Īśvara: “Rudra is eleven *vyūhas*.” Here [are meant] the words of the *Mahābhārata*: “Ajaikapāt, Ahirbudhnya, Virūpākṣa, then Raivata, Hara, Bahurūpa, Tryambaka the lord of the gods, Sāvitra, Jayanta, Pinākī and Aparājita.” Likewise “eight bodies”: “Earth, water, fire, air and ether, the sun and the moon, and the performer of the *soma* sacrifice — these are the eight forms,” says Yādava. “Usually” — because

the Rudra who dwells in the covering of water [around the universe] is seen to have one face.

Next [the author] speaks of his belonging to the category of *jīvas*: “Sometimes….” In the *Ṛg-veda*: “Whom I wish, him I make fierce, him a Brahmā, him a sage, him wise,” and so on. In the *Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad*, beginning with the words “Then the Person Nārāyaṇa desired, ‘Let Me create beings’”: “From Nārāyaṇa Brahmā is born, from Nārāyaṇa Rudra is born, from Nārāyaṇa Prajāpati is born, from Nārāyaṇa Indra is born, from Nārāyaṇa the eight Vasus (are born), from Nārāyaṇa the eleven Rudras (are born), from Nārāyaṇa the twelve Ādityas” (*Nārāyaṇa Upaniṣad* 1), and so on. In the *Mahā Upaniṣad*, beginning with the words “There was only Nārāyaṇa; there was neither Brahmā nor Īśāna”: “From the forehead of Him, absorbed in meditation, was born a three-eyed Person holding a trident, endowed with beauty, truth, celibacy, austerity and renunciation” (*Mahā Upaniṣad* 1–2), and so on. And in the *Mokṣa-dharma*: “Prajāpati and Rudra too I Myself create. But they do not know Me, bewildered by My *māyā*.” These statements speak of his birth — so here Hara is a *jīva*. Hence for him there is also destruction. In the *Viṣṇu-dharma*: “Brahmā, Śambhu, and likewise the Sun, the Moon, Śatakratu and others, as well as the rest, are endowed with the potency of Viṣṇu. But when their work in the world is over, they are deprived of that potency; and, deprived of potency, they all die.” The *śruti* “There was only one…” says the same. Otherwise these [statements] would be contradicted. The example here is “as of Brahmā (Vidhi).” “As in the case of Śeṣa”: Śeṣa, who serves as the bed of the Lord of the Śārṅga bow — His supporting potency — belongs to the category of Īśvara, while [the Śeṣa] who holds up the earth is a *jīva* empowered by Him. “For he is glorified as a part [of the Lord]” means that in the Purāṇas he is called both His *svāṁśa* and His *vibhinnāṁśa*.

But that Hara who in the verse *sattvaṁ rajas tamaḥ* is named as a manifestation of the Supreme Person — “being the abode of the Puruṣa,” that is, being He Himself — is indeed *nirguṇa*. “Almost” — because he is covered by *tamas*, which he accepted by his own will. Therefore “everyone,” that is, those who do not know the truth, “sees him here as subject to change,” among the *guṇa-avatāras*; in reality he is changeless — that is the meaning. To prove that “because of his connection with *tamas* he is seen as subject to change,” [the author] cites “Śiva … with his potency….” Śiva is Rudra; “always” — at all times; “with his potency” — with *prakṛti*, the state of equilibrium of the *guṇas*, which he accepted by his own will; “joined.” When the *guṇas* are agitated, he “has three marks,” that is,

the three *guṇas*; and when they are manifest, he is “covered” by them from afar. If one asks, “It is well known that he is covered by *tamas*; why then is he said here to have three marks?” — we answer: the three *guṇas* are mixed with one another, so *sattva* and *rajas* are also present there; there is no contradiction. And this statement itself should be understood as a restatement (*anuvāda*) of how people see him.

The proof that [Hara] is *nirguṇa* as the abode of the Puruṣa, and is called changing because of his connection with *tamas*, is “As milk….” As milk, joined with a particular transforming agent, becomes yogurt, and the yogurt is not separate, not different, from its cause, the milk, so “He” — Govinda — joined with the *tamas* He accepts by His own will, becomes Śambhu; that is, Śambhu is not other than Govinda. And since the change comes from outside, it does not touch His own nature (*svarūpa*).

[The author] names the sources from which Rudra appears: “of Brahmā….” “From the forehead of Brahmā” is found in the *Śatapatha-brāhmaṇa* and others; “from the forehead of the Lord of Kamalā” — in the *Mahā Upaniṣad* (2) and in the Purāṇas; this is possible because the *kalpas* differ. “Kālāgni-Rudra” should be understood from the words of the Eleventh Canto: “Beginning from Pātāla-tala, the fire from Saṅkarṣaṇa's mouth…” (*Bhāgavatam* 11.3.10).

One may object: “The author of the scripture, having found [such] statements, decided that Kṛṣṇa is the Lord Himself (*svayaṁ-prabhu*), that Nārāyaṇa and others are His *vilāsas* and *svāṁśas* and some are *āveśas*; that from His *svāṁśa* Garbhodaśāyī [come] Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Rudra; that they are Īśvaras, while Brahmā and Rudra are sometimes *jīvas*. But this is not skillful. The original Truth is Sadāśiva: He is meant by the word ‘Himself,’ and He also takes the forms of Nārāyaṇa and others. Therefore the three — Brahmā and the rest — are His effects; for the *Kaivalya Upaniṣad* (6–9) says: ‘Meditating on Him who is inconceivable, unmanifest, infinite in forms, auspicious (*śiva*), serene, immortal, the womb of Brahman; without beginning, middle or end, one, all-pervading, consciousness and bliss, formless, wondrous; the companion of Umā, the Supreme Lord, the master, three-eyed, blue-throated, serene — the sage reaches the Source of all beings, the Witness of all, Him who is beyond darkness. He is Brahmā, He is Śiva, He is Indra, He is the Imperishable, the Supreme, the self-ruling Lord. He is Viṣṇu, He is *prāṇa*, He is the fire of time, He is the moon. He is all that was and that will be, the moving and the unmoving. Knowing Him, one passes beyond death; there is no other path to liberation.’ So this view is better,

being based on *śruti*.” To this [the author] answers: “Sadāśiva….” That form is a part of the Lord Himself, Kṛṣṇa; Nārāyaṇa is His *vilāsa* — that is the meaning. That is why the Taittirīyas read “Śiva,” “Acyuta” and “Nārāyaṇa” in one sense. In the [cited] *śruti*, “Umā” means glory, and “the companion of Umā” is one accompanied by glory; “three-eyed” means knowing the three times; “blue-throated” means one whose throat is adorned with a blue gem (*nīla*). So it should be explained, for the ordinary meanings do not apply to that Śiva. “In the *Vāyu Purāṇa* and others”: “in Śivaloka” means in the abode of Vaikuṇṭha. This Sadāśiva and His world were described by the author of the *Sandarbhas* with the words of the *Vāyu Purāṇa* that begin “All around the waters….”

[The author] cites the decisive statement that Sadāśiva is a form of Kṛṣṇa Himself, the *svayaṁ-rūpa*: “Niyati….” The words “and so on” include the following: “The desire of Hari is the great seed. These progeny of Maheśvara were born having the nature of *liṅga* and *yoni*. This Puruṣa, the possessor of potency, is Maheśvara in the form of the *liṅga*. In that *liṅga* appeared Mahā-Viṣṇu, the Lord of the world” (*Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.8–10). The meaning is as follows. Earlier His sport with Ramā was mentioned. What is that Ramā like? It is said: “*niyati*” — she who is held, fixed in Him, the lover; that is, she is inseparable from Him and part of His own nature. Hence it is said: “His beloved, obedient to Him.” For the *Hayaśīrṣa-pañcarātra* says: “There is no Devī without Viṣṇu, and no Viṣṇu without the lotus-born one,” and the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: “Eternal indeed is she, Śrī, the mother of the world, inseparable from Viṣṇu” (*Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 1.8.15). Bhagavān Śambhu is the “*liṅga*” of that *svayaṁ-rūpa*, that is, His sign: “*Liṅga* — in the sense of sign and of inference,” says the *Viśva* [lexicon]. Bhagavān is the Lord of Paravyoma, possessed of the six opulences. “Śambhu” is He who, as His second *vyūha* Saṅkarṣaṇa, brings welfare (*śam*) to the *jīvas* dissolved in *prakṛti* by creating their respective *upādhis*; “whose form is light” — whose form is consciousness. Kṛṣṇa's being Lord over Him reveals that Kṛṣṇa is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, as a cow is recognized by its dewlap and other marks: He of whom this [Śambhu] is the *vilāsa* is [Bhagavān] Himself; that is why [Śambhu] is called His *liṅga*. “She who is the *yoni*” — the material cause of the *mahat* and the rest — “is the *aparā śakti*,” that is, consisting of the three *guṇas*. “Of Hari” — of His part, Saṅkarṣaṇa; “desire” — His desire to glance [at her] — bears fruit in the creation of the *mahat* and the rest; hence “the great seed.” “Great” — the immeasurable *jīva-tattva* — is placed in her. Therefore “these progeny of Maheśvara, having the nature of *liṅga* and *yoni*,” are said to be born from the

Puruṣa and *prakṛti* as their causes. Since *prakṛti* is secondary and depends on Him, the progeny are called “of Maheśvara”: this he establishes with the words “the possessor of potency….” Then he clarifies what was said: “In that….” “In the *liṅga*” — in her Lord, in His presence. Mahā-Viṣṇu is Saṅkarṣaṇa.

কৃষ্ণপ্রেমে উন্মত্ত, বিহ্বল দিগম্বর ।
কৃষ্ণ-গুণ-লীলা গায়, নাচে নিরন্তর ॥ ৭৯ ॥

kṛṣṇa-preme unmatta, vihvala digambara
in love for Kṛṣṇa mad overwhelmed unclothed
kṛṣṇa-guṇa-līlā gāya, nāce nirantara
Kṛṣṇa's qualities pastimes he sings dances constantly

79 Mad with love for Kṛṣṇa, overwhelmed and unclothed, he constantly sings of Kṛṣṇa's qualities and pastimes and dances.

*(13) Service to Kṛṣṇa runs through all four *rasas* — conjugal, parental, friendly and servile —*

পিতা-মাতা-গুরু-সখা-ভাব কেনে নয় ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রেমের স্বভাবে দাস্য-ভাব সে করয় ॥ ৮০ ॥

pitā-mātā-guru-sakhā-bhāva kene naya
of father mother elder friend the mood whatever it may be
kṛṣṇa-premera svabhāve dāsya-bhāva se karaya
of love for Kṛṣṇa by the nature servant's mood it produces

80 Whether one's mood is that of a father, a mother, an elder or a friend, love for Kṛṣṇa by its very nature produces the mood of a servant.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Whatever mood [toward Kṛṣṇa] one may take up, one must certainly acknowledge the mood of a servant (*dāsya*) contained within every mood.

Kṛṣṇa Himself is the Lord of all —

এক কৃষ্ণ — সর্ব্বসেব্য, জগৎ-ঈশ্বর ।
আর যত সব, — তাঁর সেবকানুচর ॥ ৮১ ॥

eka kṛṣṇa — sarva-sevya, jagat-īśvara
one Kṛṣṇa served by all of the world the Lord
āra yata saba, — tāṅra sevakānucara
and as many all His servants and followers

81 Kṛṣṇa alone is the Lord of the world, the one whom all serve. All others are His servants and followers.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.70, 83, 88, 102, 106; 3.5; 4.11–12; 5.131; 7.7–8; Madhya 6.147; 8.133–135; 10.15; 15.139; 18.190–191; 20.152–155, 240, 400; 21.3, 92; 22.7; 24.71 and others.

সেই কৃষ্ণ অবতীর্ণ — চৈতন্য-ঈশ্বর ।
অতএব আর সব, — তাঁহার কিঙ্কর ॥ ৮২ ॥

sei kṛṣṇa avatīrṇa — caitanya-īśvara
that Kṛṣṇa descended Caitanya the Lord
ataeva āra saba, — tāṅhāra kiṅkara
therefore the others all His servants

82 That same Kṛṣṇa has descended as Lord Caitanya; therefore all others are His servants.

(14) Everything spiritual other than He is His servant —

কেহ মানে, কেহ না মানে, সব তাঁর দাস ।
যে না মানে, তার হয় সেই পাপে নাশ ॥ ৮৩ ॥

keha māne, keha nā māne, saba tāṅra dāsa
some accept some not accept all His servants
ye nā māne, tāra haya sei pāpe nāśa
who not accepts of him there is by that sin ruin

83 Some accept this and some do not, but all are His servants. One who does not accept it is ruined by that very sin.

Anubhāṣya.

Forgetting his true nature, the *jīva* puts on the costume of an enjoyer and turns away from serving Kṛṣṇa. And some, out of ignorance, at times think that service to Bhagavān is not their only duty. But in fact every living being eternally abides in His service. If the *jīva* does not serve Bhagavān, his nature is overturned and misfortune arrives. Service to Śrī Caitanya is the intrinsic duty (*svarūpa-dharma*) of the *jīva*, an atomic particle of spirit. When the conditioned *jīva* forgets the function of his true nature and strives for something else, it is only the pull of enjoying matter. When consciousness (*caitanya*) awakens in him, service to Caitanya naturally manifests in his heart. Deprived of service to Caitanya, the conditioned *jīva* in his undertakings comes to lord it over other things; but even then he is only an unworthy servant of Caitanya.

চৈতন্যের দাস মুঞি, চৈতন্যের দাস ।
চৈতন্যের দাস মুঞি, তাঁর দাসের দাস ॥ ৮৪ ॥

caitanyera dāsa muñi, caitanyera dāsa
Caitanya's servant I Caitanya's servant
caitanyera dāsa muñi, tāṅra dāsera dāsa
Caitanya's servant I His servants' servant

84 [Advaita says:] “I am Caitanya's servant, Caitanya's servant! I am Caitanya's servant, the servant of His servants!”

এত বলি’ নাচে, গায়, হুঙ্কার গম্ভীর ।
ক্ষণেকে বসিলা আচার্য্য হৈঞা সুস্থির ॥ ৮৫ ॥

eta bali’ nāce, gāya, huṅkāra gambhīra
so saying He dances sings roaring deep
kṣaṇeke vasilā ācārya haiñā susthira
in a moment sat down the Ācārya becoming calm

85 Saying this, He dances and sings with deep roars; then, a moment later, the Ācārya grows calm and sits down.

*Baladeva and all His *aṁśa-avatāras* regard Themselves as servants of Kṛṣṇa —*

ভক্ত-অভিমান মূল শ্রীবলরামে ।
সেই ভাবে অনুগত তাঁর অংশগণে ॥ ৮৬ ॥

bhakta-abhimāna mūla śrī-balarāme
devotee's self-conception the root in Śrī Balarāma
sei bhāve anugata tāṅra aṁśa-gaṇe
that mood follow His portions

86 The root of the self-conception of a devotee is in Śrī Balarāma, and all His portions follow that mood.

(1) His avatāra Saṅkarṣaṇa regards Himself as a servant —

তাঁর অবতার এক শ্রীসঙ্কর্ষণ ।
ভক্ত বলি' অভিমান করে সর্ব্বক্ষণ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

tāṅra avatāra eka śrī-saṅkarṣaṇa
His avatāra one Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa
bhakta bali' abhimāna kare sarva-kṣaṇa
a devotee as self-conception holds always

87 One of His avatāras, Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa, always thinks of Himself as a devotee.

(2) His avatāra Lakṣmaṇa regards Himself as a servant —

তাঁর অবতার আন শ্রীযুত লক্ষ্মণ ।
শ্রীরামের দাস্য তিঁহো কৈল অনুক্ষণ ॥ ৮৮ ॥

tāṅra avatāra āna śrī-yuta lakṣmaṇa
His avatāra another the glorious Lakṣmaṇa
śrī-rāmera dāsya tiṅho kaila anukṣaṇa
of Śrī Rāma service He did at every moment

88 Another of His avatāras, the glorious Lakṣmaṇa, served Śrī Rāma at every moment.

(3) His avatāra the original Puruṣa also regards Himself as a devotee —

সঙ্কর্ষণ-অবতার কারণাব্ধিশায়ী ।
তাঁহার হৃদয়ে ভক্ত-ভাব অনুয়ায়ী ॥ ৮৯ ॥

saṅkarṣaṇa-avatāra kāraṇābdhi-śāyī
Saṅkarṣaṇa's avatāra lying in the Causal Ocean
tāṅhāra hṛdaye bhakta-bhāva anuyāyī
His in the heart devotee's mood accordingly

89 The Lord who lies in the Causal Ocean is an avatāra of Saṅkarṣaṇa, and accordingly the mood of a devotee fills His heart too.

(4) His avatāra Advaita also regards Himself as a devotee —

তাঁহার প্রকাশ-ভেদ, অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্য ।
কায়মনোবাক্যে তাঁর ভক্তি সদা কার্য্য ॥ ৯০ ॥

tāṅhāra prakāśa-bheda, advaita-ācārya
His manifestation distinct Advaita Ācārya
kāya-mano-vākye tāṅra bhakti sadā kārya
with body mind words His devotion always the work

90 Advaita Ācārya is a distinct manifestation of Him, and devotion with body, mind and words is always His work.

বাক্যে কহে, মুঞি চৈতন্যের অনুচর ।
মুঞি তাঁর ভক্ত — মনে ভাবে নিরন্তর ॥ ৯১ ॥

vākye kahe, muñi caitanyera anucara
in words He says I Caitanya's follower
muñi tāṅra bhakta — mane bhāve nirantara
I His devotee in mind He thinks constantly

91 In words He says, “I am Caitanya's follower,” and in His mind He constantly thinks, “I am His devotee.”

জল-তুলসী দিয়া করে কায়াতে সেবন ।
ভক্তি প্রচারিয়া সব তারিলা ভুবন ॥ ৯২ ॥

jala-tulasī diyā kare kāyāte sevana
water tulasī offering He renders with the body service
bhakti pracāriyā saba tārilā bhuvana
bhakti preaching the whole He delivered world

92 With His body He serves by offering water and tulasī, and by preaching bhakti He delivered the whole world.

(5) His avatāra Śeṣa also regards Himself as a servant —

পৃথিবী ধরেন যেই শেষ-সঙ্কর্ষণ ।
কায়ব্যূহ করি' করেন কৃষ্ণের সেবন ॥ ৯৩ ॥

pṛthivī dharena yei śeṣa-saṅkarṣaṇa
the earth holds who Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa
kāya-vyūha kari' karena kṛṣṇera sevana
bodily expansions making renders to Kṛṣṇa service

93 Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa, who holds up the earth, expands into many bodies (*kāya-vyūha*) to serve Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
Kāya-vyūha means the ten bodies. See verse 76.

*All of Kṛṣṇa's *aṁśa-avatāras* are His devotees —*

এই সব হয় শ্রীকৃষ্ণের অবতার ।
নিরন্তর দেখি সবার ভক্তির আচার ॥ ৯৪ ॥

ei saba haya śrī-kṛṣṇera avatāra
these all are of Śrī Kṛṣṇa avatāras
nirantara dekhi sabāra bhaktira ācāra
constantly we see of all of devotion the conduct

94 All of these are avatāras of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, yet we always see Them behave as devotees.

*The supreme dignity of the *bhakta-avatāra* —*

এ সবাকে শাস্ত্রে কহে 'ভক্ত-অবতার' ।
'ভক্ত-অবতার' পদ উপরি সবার ॥ ৯৫ ॥

e sabāke śāstre kahe 'bhakta-avatāra'
them all in scripture call avatāras as devotees
'bhakta-avatāra' pada upari sabāra
of the avatāra as a devotee the position above all

95 Scripture calls Them all avatāras as devotees (*bhakta-avatāras*), and the position of an avatāra as a devotee is above all others.

Anubhāṣya.

Bhagavān descends into the material world to display His majesty. But for the welfare of the *jīva*, higher and more needful than all the pastimes of these Īśvara-avatāras is the exemplary *bhakta-avatāra*, who awakens in the *jīva* an understanding of how to serve [the Lord]. Trying to see the avatāras in whom majesty predominates through knowledge born of the senses, the *jīva* often comes to grief; but when he sees an avatāra of Bhagavān in the form of a devotee, his false ego cannot draw bad fruit from such an example. Many ignorant people, while being *jīvas*, call themselves "Vāsudeva" and the like, and after death take birth as jackals. Such a fate befalls precisely those who are bewildered and do not see the true nature of the *bhakta-avatāras*. False ego intoxicates the conditioned *jīva* with a craving for the majesty of Bhagavān and turns him into a Māyāvādī.

*The behavior of elder and younger between the *aṁśa-avatāras* and Kṛṣṇa, the whole (*aṁśī*) —*

একমাত্র 'অংশী' — কৃষ্ণ, 'অংশ' — অবতার ।
অংশী-অংশে দেখি জ্যেষ্ঠ-কনিষ্ঠ-আচার ॥ ৯৬ ॥

eka-mātra 'aṁśī' — kṛṣṇa, 'aṁśa' — avatāra
the one only source of portions Kṛṣṇa portions the avatāras
aṁśī-aṁśe dekhi jyeṣṭha-kaniṣṭha-ācāra
in the source and the portion we see of elder younger the conduct

96 Kṛṣṇa alone is the source of all portions (*aṁśī*), and the avatāras are His portions (*aṁśas*). Between the source and the portion we see the

conduct of elder and younger.

*An elder *aṁśa-avatāra* sees the younger *aṁśī* as master, and a younger *aṁśa-avatāra* regards himself as servant of the elder *aṁśī* —*

জ্যেষ্ঠ-ভাবে অংশীতে হয় প্রভু-জ্ঞান ।
কনিষ্ঠ-ভাবে আপনাতে ভক্ত-অভিমান ॥ ৯৭ ॥

jyeṣṭha-bhāve aṁśīte haya prabhu-jñāna
in the elder's mood toward the source there is as Master awareness
kaniṣṭha-bhāve āpanāte bhakta-abhimāna
in the younger's mood in oneself devotee self-conception

97 Seeing the source as the elder, the portion regards Him as Master; seeing Himself as the younger, He thinks of Himself as a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

A separated portion of a thing is called *aṁśa*, and that of which it is a portion is the *aṁśī*. The part of the *aṁśī*, the portion of the undivided, is contained within the *aṁśī*, within the undivided. The *aṁśī* is the master (*prabhu*), the *aṁśa* is the devotee (*bhakta*). The relationship of “master” and “devotee” includes the distinction of elder and younger, greater and lesser: the greater is called “*prabhu*,” the lesser “*bhakta*.” The *aṁśī* is Kṛṣṇa; the *aṁśas* are Baladeva and the manifestations of Mahā-Viṣṇu who share His nature. Kṛṣṇa regards Himself as the Lord, and Baladeva and the others regard Themselves as devotees.

With Kṛṣṇa the devotee receives the highest honor —

কৃষ্ণের সমতা হৈতে বড় ভক্তপদ ।
আত্মা হৈতে কৃষ্ণের ভক্ত হয় প্রেমাস্পদ ॥ ৯৮ ॥

kṛṣṇera samatā haite baḍa bhakta-pada
with Kṛṣṇa equality than greater a devotee's position
ātmā haite kṛṣṇera bhakta haya premāspada
than His self Kṛṣṇa's devotee is the object of love

98 The position of a devotee is greater than equality with Kṛṣṇa, for Kṛṣṇa loves His devotee more than His own self.

Anubhāṣya.

The position of Kṛṣṇa's devotee, that is, the devotee's service to Kṛṣṇa, is higher than the idea of equality with Kṛṣṇa: for Kṛṣṇa loves His servant more than He loves His own interests. The best evidence of this is the verse of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (9.4.68): “The sādhus are My heart, and I am the heart of the sādhus. They know nothing but Me, and I know nothing but them.”

আত্মা হৈতে কৃষ্ণ ভক্তে বড় করি’ মানে ।
ইহাতে বহুত শাস্ত্র-বচন প্রমাণে ॥ ৯৯ ॥

ātmā haite kṛṣṇa bhakte baḍa kari’ māne
His self than Kṛṣṇa the devotee greater as considers
ihāte bahuta śāstra-vacana pramāṇe
to this many of scripture statements testify

99 Kṛṣṇa considers His devotee greater than Himself, and many statements of scripture testify to this.

*(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.14.15)*

ন তথা মে প্রিয়তম আত্ম-যোনির্ন শঙ্করঃ ।
ন চ সঙ্কর্ষণো ন শ্রীর্নৈবাত্মা চ যথা ভবান্ ॥ ১০০ ॥

na tathā me priya-tama
not so to Me dear
ātma-yonir na śaṅkaraḥ
the self-born nor Śaṅkara
na ca saṅkarṣaṇo na śrīr
nor and Saṅkarṣaṇa nor Śrī
naivātmā ca yathā bhavān
nor even My self and as you

100 “Neither Brahmā, who was born from Me, nor Śaṅkara, nor Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Śrī, nor even My own self is as dear to Me as you are.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.14.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Uddhava! Neither Brahmā, nor Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Lakṣmī, nor even I Myself am as dear to Me as you, My devotee, are dear to Me.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa's words to Uddhava, the best of His devotees:

me (to Me) **yathā bhavān** (you, Uddhava) **priyatamaḥ** (the devotee), [so] **ātma-yoniḥ** (Brahmā) **tathā na**; **śaṅkaraḥ tathā na**; **saṅkarṣaṇaḥ ca na tathā priyatamaḥ**; **śrīḥ** (Lakṣmī) **tathā na**, **ātmā tathā na eva** (not even I Myself, My divine form, am so dear).

Only in the mood of a devotee does Kṛṣṇa taste His own sweetness —

কৃষ্ণসাম্যে নহে তাঁর মাধুর্য্যাস্বাদন ।
ভক্তভাবে করে তাঁর মাধুর্য্য চর্ব্বণ ॥ ১০১ ॥

kṛṣṇa-sāmye nahe tāṅra mādhuryāsvādana
in equality with Kṛṣṇa not is His sweetness tasting
bhakta-bhāve kare tāṅra mādhurya carvaṇa
in the mood of a devotee one does His sweetness relishing

101 In equality with Kṛṣṇa there is no tasting of His sweetness; it is in the mood of a devotee that one relishes it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

One who regards himself as Kṛṣṇa's equal does not taste His sweetness.

Thus ends the sixth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

শাস্ত্রের সিদ্ধান্ত এই, — বিজ্ঞের অনুভব ।
মূঢ়লোক নাহি জানে ভাবের বৈভব ॥ ১০২ ॥

śāstrera siddhānta ei, — vijñera anubhava
of scripture the conclusion this of the wise the experience
mūḍha-loka nāhi jāne bhāvera vaibhava
foolish people not know of the mood the glory

102 This is the conclusion of scripture and the experience of the wise. Foolish people do not know the glory of this mood.

Anubhāṣya.

In *sārūpya* and the other kinds of liberation, and in *viṣṇu-tattva*, there is [a sense of] equality with Kṛṣṇa, so the sweetness of service to Kṛṣṇa is not tasted so [fully]. In the mood of a devotee there is no equality with Kṛṣṇa (no position of enjoyer), and so Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is fully realized, like the taste of food that is chewed. Ordinary people, out of foolishness and greed for mastery, are by their very nature unable to experience the highest limit of the servant's mood. Only those who are highly experienced and have entered deeply into the scriptures can understand this subtle subject.

Nityānanda, Rāma and the other Viṣṇus taste Kṛṣṇa's sweetness only in the mood of devotees —

ভক্তভাব অঙ্গীকরি’ বলরাম, লক্ষ্মণ ।
অদ্বৈত, নিত্যানন্দ, শেষ, সঙ্কর্ষণ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

কৃষ্ণের মাধুর্য্যরসামৃত করে পান ।
সেই সুখে মত্ত, কিছু নাহি জানে আন ॥ ১০৪ ॥

bhakta-bhāva aṅgīkari’ balarāma, lakṣmaṇa
devotee's mood accepting Balarāma Lakṣmaṇa
advaita, nityānanda, śeṣa, saṅkarṣaṇa
Advaita Nityānanda Śeṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa
kṛṣṇera mādhurya-rasāmṛta kare pāna
Kṛṣṇa's sweetness rasa nectar do drink
sei sukhe matta, kichu nāhi jāne āna
in that joy intoxicated anything not know else

103–104 Accepting the mood of devotees, Balarāma, Lakṣmaṇa, Advaita, Nityānanda, Śeṣa and Saṅkarṣaṇa drink the nectar of the rasa of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness. Intoxicated with that joy, They know nothing else.

To taste His own sweetness, Kṛṣṇa Himself descends in the mood of a devotee

as Gaura —

অন্যের আছুক্ কার্য্য, আপনে শ্রীকৃষ্ণ ।
আপন-মাধুর্য্য-পানে হইলা সতৃষ্ণ ॥ ১০৫ ॥

anyera āchuk kārya, āpane śrī-kṛṣṇa
of others let it be the matter Himself Śrī Kṛṣṇa
āpana-mādhurya-pāne hailā satṛṣṇa
His own sweetness to drink became thirsty

105 Let alone others: Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself became thirsty to drink His own sweetness.

স্বমাধুর্য্য আস্বাদিতে করেন যতন ।
ভক্তভাব বিনু নহে তাহা আস্বাদন ॥ ১০৬ ॥

svamādhurya āsvādite karena yatana
His own sweetness to taste He makes effort
bhakta-bhāva vinu nahe tāhā āsvādana
devotee's mood without not is of it the tasting

106 He strives to taste His own sweetness, but without the mood of a devotee it cannot be tasted.

Anubhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa, the object of the devotees' worship, wished to know how the devotees taste His sweetness. Understanding that it cannot be tasted without accepting the mood of a devotee, He Himself became a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.137–158.

Tasting His own sweetness in the mood of a devotee —

ভক্তভাব অঙ্গীকরি' হৈলা অবতীর্ণ ।
শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্যরূপে সর্ব্বভাবে পূর্ণ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

bhakta-bhāva aṅgīkari' hailā avatīrṇa
devotee's mood accepting He became descended
śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-rūpe sarva-bhāve pūrṇa
in the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya in all moods complete

107 So, accepting the mood of a devotee, He descended as Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, complete in every mood.

নানা-ভক্তভাবে করেন স্বমাধুর্য্য পান ।
পূর্ব্বে করিয়াছি এই সিদ্ধান্ত ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ১০৮ ॥

nānā-bhakta-bhāve karena sva-mādhurya pāna
in various devotees' moods He does His own sweetness drinking
pūrve kariyāchi ei siddhānta vyākhyāna
before I have made this conclusion the explanation

108 In the various moods of devotees He drinks His own sweetness. I have explained this conclusion before.

Anubhāṣya.
To taste the five different *rasas* — *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* — Śrī Gaurahari accepted the mood of each, and so He is full of every mood. Accepting the moods of devotees who take shelter of different *bhāvas*, Gauracandra, full of every mood, drinks His own sweetness.

The mood of a devotee belongs to all the avatāras of Viṣṇu —

অবতারগণের ভক্তভাবে অধিকার ।
ভক্তভাব হৈতে অধিক সুখ নাহি আর ॥ ১০৯ ॥

avatāra-gaṇera bhakta-bhāve adhikāra
of the avatāras in the devotee's mood the right
bhakta-bhāva haite adhika sukha nāhi āra
than the devotee's mood greater happiness there is not other

109 The avatāras have a claim to the mood of a devotee, for there is no happiness greater than the mood of a devotee.

Anubhāṣya.

All the avatāras of Viṣṇu are entitled to descend in the mood of a devotee for the sake of serving Kṛṣṇa. One who tastes [*rasa*] feels more happiness in serving the One who is served in the mood of a devotee than in the mood of Īśvara.

*Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original *bhakta-avatāra* —*

মূল-ভক্ত-অবতার শ্রীসঙ্কর্ষণ ।
ভক্ত-অবতার তঁহি অদ্বৈতে গণন ॥ ১১০ ॥

mūla-bhakta-avatāra śrī-saṅkarṣaṇa
the original devotee avatāra Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa
bhakta-avatāra taṅhi advaite gaṇana
devotee avatāra there in Advaita the counting

110 Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa is the original avatāra as a devotee, and Advaita is counted among the avatāras as devotees.

Anubhāṣya.
Advaita Prabhu is *viṣṇu-tattva*, yet He displayed the pastimes of a servant befitting an associate of Śrī Caitanya. Regarding Himself as a servant is precisely what makes a *viṣṇu-tattva* a *bhakta-avatāra*. Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa in Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha, though He abides as the Īśvara of the *catur-vyūha*, is the original *bhakta-avatāra*. From Him [comes] Mahā-Viṣṇu in the Causal Waters, and through the differences of His manifestations we learn of [His] glance (*īkṣaṇa*) in the efficient and material [causes]. Therefore Śrī Advaitācārya, the avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu, is Śrī *viṣṇu-tattva*. All the manifestations of Saṅkarṣaṇa are engaged in the service of Kṛṣṇa, the *svayaṁ-rūpa* — therefore Advaita Prabhu too is a servant of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa, that is, a *bhakta-avatāra*.

The glory of Advaita Prabhu —

অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্য গোসাঞির মহিমা অপার ।
যাঁহার হুঙ্কারে কৈল চৈতন্যাবতার ॥ ১১১ ॥

advaita-ācārya gosāñira mahimā apāra
of Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi the greatness boundless
yāṅhāra huṅkāre kaila caitanyāvatāra
by whose roaring call was made Caitanya's descent

111 The greatness of Advaita Ācārya is boundless: His roaring call brought about the descent of Śrī Caitanya.

সঙ্কীর্ত্তন প্রচারিয়া সব জগৎ তারিল ।
অদ্বৈত-প্রসাদে লোক প্রেমধন পাইল ॥ ১১২ ॥

saṅkīrtana pracāriyā saba jagat tārila
saṅkīrtana spreading the whole world He delivered
advaita-prasāde loka prema-dhana pāila
by Advaita's mercy people of love the treasure obtained

112 By spreading *saṅkīrtana* He delivered the whole world. By Advaita's mercy people obtained the treasure of love.

অদ্বৈত-মহিমা অনন্ত কে পারে কহিতে ।
সেই লিখি, যেই শুনি মহাজন হৈতে ॥ ১১৩ ॥

advaita-mahimā ananta ke pāre kahite
of Advaita the greatness unlimited who can tell
sei likhi, yei śuni mahājana haite
that I write which I hear great souls from

113 Who can tell Advaita's unlimited greatness? I write only what I have heard from great souls (*mahājanas*).

Homage to Ācārya Prabhu —

আচার্য্য-চরণে মোর কোটি নমস্কার ।
ইথে কিছু অপরাধ না লবে আমার ॥ ১১৪ ॥

ācārya-caraṇe mora koṭi namaskāra
at the Ācārya's feet my ten million obeisances
ithe kichu aparādha nā labe āmāra
in this any offense not may He take my

114 Ten million obeisances at the Ācārya's feet! May He not count any offense of mine in this.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the sixth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

তোমার মহিমা — কোটিসমুদ্র অগাধ ।
তাহার ইয়ত্তা কহি — এ বড় অপরাধ ॥ ১১৫ ॥

tomāra mahimā — koṭi-samudra agādha
Your greatness ten million oceans unfathomable
tāhāra iyattā kahi — e baḍa aparādha
of it the measure I tell this great offense

115 Your greatness is unfathomable, like ten million oceans. To speak of its measure is a great offense.

জয় জয় জয় শ্রীঅদ্বৈত আচার্য্য ।
জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য, নিত্যানন্দ আর্য্য ॥ ১১৬ ॥

jaya jaya jaya śrī-advaita ācārya
glory glory glory to Śrī Advaita Ācārya
jaya jaya śrī-caitanya, nityānanda ārya
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya to Nityānanda the noble

116 All glory, all glory to Śrī Advaita Ācārya! All glory to Śrī Caitanya and to the noble Nityānanda!

দুই শ্লোকে কহিল অদ্বৈত-তত্ত্বনিরূপণ ।
পঞ্চতত্ত্বের বিচার কিছু শুন, ভক্তগণ ॥ ১১৭ ॥

dui śloke kahila advaita-tattva-nirūpaṇa
in two verses I have told of Advaita's truth the description
pañca-tattvera vicāra kichu śuna, bhakta-gaṇa
of the Pañca-tattva the analysis a little hear O devotees

117 In two verses I have described the truth about Advaita. Now, O devotees, hear a little about the Pañca-tattva.

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১১৮ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
Caitanya-caritāmṛta tells Kṛṣṇadāsa

118 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, tell the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The verse translation reads differently: “the happiness of abiding in the effulgence of Brahman.” ↩
2. The edition reads *nija-jana-sandoha (garva)* (“of the multitude of His own people (pride)”); the verse has *smaya* (pride). Translated according to the verse. ↩
3. *Manu-saṁhitā* 1.5–9. ↩
4. *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 1.1.31. ↩
5. *Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 4.4.22. ↩
6. *Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 1.2.15. ↩
7. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.5.15. ↩
8. *Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 5.2. ↩
9. So in the edition; in the Sanskrit text of the *Govinda-bhāṣya* this point concerns the *smṛtis* of Manu and others. ↩
10. In Sanskrit, *jñānāvarodhanāt*, “because of an obstruction (checking) of knowledge”; the passage is understood in the same way in the translation of the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (22): “having given up the path of (dry) knowledge.” ↩
11. The verse translation reads differently: “the happiness of abiding in the effulgence of Brahman.” ↩
12. *Dāmodarāṣṭaka* 4 and 7. ↩
13. So in the edition; according to the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.46–47), Uddhava came to Vraja from Mathurā and returned there. ↩
14. Unclear place in the scan: after “speaks” the edition has *śrīti* (apparently a garbled pratīka of the verse). ↩